



WINTER IN OUR BONES
WATER TO OUR SOULS

Michigan is a folksy pop rock musical that follows Lulu and Petoskey, a Dearborn girl and Yooper boy, fight a data center to save their grandparents' lake house and the world.

Michigan

Michigan

Inspired by
The MacGregor Family
David Quang Pham's Childhood
&
In Loving Memory of
Carly Glynn
September 24, 1992 – February 10, 2011
Jeremy Swiatek
April 23, 1996 - September 15, 2019
Tiffany Marie Emmert
April 29, 1996 – January 19, 2026
James Emmert
May 5, 1991 – January 19, 2026
Andrew Van Otteren
March 17, 1994 - July 12, 2026

Because of you, David and many others love musicals and Michigan.

Michigan

THANK YOU

Feedback 2026-Now

Marilyn Chau, Lukas Jacob, May Perez, Mia Soriano, Camille Thomas

Theatre People Party & Salon with Jen & Matt Coogan 2026

Beth Barton, Denise Gillott, Kayla Katona, Andrea Rae, Jake Sheffer

Michigan

SYNOPSIS

Set during a family reunion in Elk Rapids, this coming-of-age musical follows Lulu and Petoskey - a Dearborn city girl and Yooper farm boy – as they stop a data center from taking over their grandparents' lake house and save the entire city. Our rock star Lulu dreams of having a spiritual connection to the land and her rocks like Petoskey has. Meanwhile, our grieving Petoskey hopes to get to know his late father and help his mother heal through water. Petoskey, the state stone and native fossil that reveals its true pattern when wet, serves as a metaphor for hidden grief and emotional depth. Lulu, “pearl” in Arabic, is a metaphor for those who try to break out of their shells.

Michigan is inspired by David Quang Pham's upbringing and the MacGregors who invite him to their Elk Rapids lake house on Harbor Days since being roommates with their family member Lukas Jacob in 2014. In 2026, after a series of suicides of his hometown and college friends in musical theatre, he began writing this musical as a love letter to his family and communities in our home Mitten.

WHY NOW?

Michigan champions human creativity, connections, and nature against the rise of harmful technologies, symbolized by the threat of a data center replacing a small-town family's lake house. By centering the narrative on the impacts of suicide and collective loss, the play addresses today's mental health crisis, offering ways to heal through open communication and community. And it uses science and folklore to bridge regional cultural divides, reminding audiences to protect both the natural environments and our shared heritages that keep us rooted.

Michigan is *Oklahoma* craziness meets *Fun Home* tenderness meets *Bright Star* folksiness.

Michigan

THEMES

Collective Grief and Emotional Healing

The story explores the long-term impact of grief after Petey's suicide and Grandma Milly's death, demonstrating how silence fractures families while open communication fosters generational healing.

Community versus Technology

The central conflict pits a warm hand-made tradition against cold corporate greed, by keeping AI data centers from erasing local heritage, such as the family's lake house.

Geographic and Cultural Disconnection

The narrative highlights how families can become polarized by peninsulas, symbolized by the physical and emotional barrier of the Mackinac Bridge separating the Upper and Lower Peninsula identities. The story leans into subcultures, contrasting Yooper (Upper Peninsula) against suburban Dearborn/Lower Peninsula dynamics.

Belonging and Identity

Through Lulu's competitive drive to outshine her cousins, the musical examines the painful adolescent struggle to fit into a Midwest family dynamic and find one's own sense of worth.

Nature, Folklore, and Science Literacy

By embedding paleontology into the musical numbers, the narrative uses the natural history of the Petoskey stone fossil to teach environmental appreciation and show how memories attach themselves to physical landscapes.

Michigan

The Immigrant Experience

This manifests through multiple layers, such as Shelby marrying an Arab man, Jasper Vinh Chin's Vietnamese restaurant (Banh MiMichigan), and his realization that his refugee family stayed united across continents while local families are divided by peninsulas. It deals heavily with how different minority communities interact within the Midwest.

Economic Displacement and Xenophobia

The backstory reveals the harsh realities of blue-collar job loss during the 2008 recession, like David's family in the automotive industry. It directly addresses the displaced anger that can arise from automated or immigrant replacement (Petey being fired and replaced by a migrant worker), showing the tragic intersection of economic desperation, racial tension, and family fallout.

The Power of Hand-Made Artistry

The family's century-old Ford Model T, their decades of hand-made costumes, and the town's rally around them showcase art and weirdness as a form of liberation.

Healing through Artistry, Spirituality, or Technology

Amanda's brother Conor and Cherry and Perry and Shelby's brother/Liz's husband Petey commit suicide off Mackinac Bridge. Amanda and Liz never crossed the bridge for years. Amanda also has disdain for water, so she makes more data centers to drain them. Amanda processes grief by losing artistry through AI while Cherry becomes more artistic and less tech-savvy.

Michigan

PLOT SUMMARY

Michigan is a folksy musical dramedy set at a family reunion where two rival cousins fight a data center to save their grandparents' lake house and world. The themes explore grief, cultural disconnection of the peninsulas, and what it means to be a Michigander.

Grampy Willy and Granny Milly live in Elk Rapids on the north tip of the Lower Peninsula. They have four adult children – Cherry, Perry, Shelby, and the only son Petey, and some grandchildren. Every August, their lake house lodges them for the annual Harbor Days. The VanDam family are known for their century-old Ford Model T, wearing themed costumes for the parade, and winning every Most Creative Award ([“The Mitten Song”](#)).

In 2008, Petey lives with his pregnant wife Lizzie in the Upper Peninsula. His childhood friend is Jasper Vinh Duong, who runs the Elk Rapids Vietnamese restaurant, BANH Michigan. On a swim, he jokily promises to name their kid after the first rock he picks up, which turns out to be a heart-shaped Petoskey with an elk symbol ([“Life is Complete”](#)).

With the recession, their shipyard job fires and replaces Petey and Liz with migrants. He then hurts his little sister Shelby due to her Arab husband. In a storm, he drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house on his life insurance. A detective finds his Petoskey. Ever since, Liz refuses to cross bridges, missing all family gatherings ([“Body of Water”](#)).

For family reunions, the aunts take turns driving Petoskey to Elk Rapids then Milly drives him home. Jasper becomes his godfather. For every Mackinac Bridge crossing, he can hear his dad sing. And then there's his bright cousin from Dearborn, Lulu Abughosh. She always competes to find the rarest stones on their swims ([“Yoopers and Trolls”](#)).

In 2020, Milly passes away, cancelling the 2020 and 2021 family reunions. Soon, data center agent Amanda Wayland tricks a grieving Willy into signing away the deed to his house by using afterlife.ai to bring Milly and Petey back to life ([“It Would Be a Shame”](#)).

In 2022, to honor Milly, 13-year-old Petoskey's mom returns for the first time since '08. They drive the long way through Wisconsin. Jasper helps the kids set up camp. He takes their snacks as “dad tax.” The aunties take even more with “mom taxes” ([“Dad Tax”](#)).

Though the family gather by the bonfire, 13-year-old Lulu is in her tent finishing a song. She revisits a time when she ran away and was saved from a car accident by deer. She thinks everyone sees her as a loser. She'd do anything to win their hearts ([“Dearborn”](#)).

They realize Amanda tricked Willy into trading the Lake House for her AI that “brings loved ones back to life.” She tours the home and sees a photo of Petoskey's heirloom. She wants it more than anything. So, he promises to trade it for the deed ([“AI Does the Work for Me”](#)).

They need to find it in Pine River ([“Wild Midwest”](#)). He revisits a memory of Lulu losing the heirloom while canoeing in 2019, severing his dad's spiritual ties. So, he gathers everyone to find it. No one does ([“Fish for Mom and Dad”](#)).

Michigan

Later that night on a dune, Lulu witnesses a deer pass by their bonfire. Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids ("[Time Does Heal](#)"), Lulu separates and discovers a deer dropping off the heirloom and other rare rocks on the shore ("[Gichigamiin](#)").

After successfully bulldozing Ypsilanti, Amanda revisits a time when she and her techy brother were artists until his suicide killed her creative spirit ("[The Starving Artist](#)").

For Harbor Days' parade, Broadway actor cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is the Grand Marshal. So, the theme is theatre. Petoskey dresses as *Oklahoma's* Jud Fry while Lulu plays Evan Hansen. Before marching, she shows her rare findings to the family. To spite Petoskey, she breaks his father's necklace, unaware it was their only chance to save the lake house from Amanda. The parade goes wrong as Petoskey beats up Lulu, disqualifying them for the first time ("[Fraudway](#)"). After his mom lectures him, he runs off ("[Kick Rocks](#)").

In the following act, Liz revisits a memory of Lulu and Petoskey at a talent show ("[Hands Come in Handy](#)"). Presently, she searches for him while Lulu tries to find him at Banh MI ("[Petoskey](#)"). Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not resort to blame as Petey had. The VanDams are only divided by peninsulas. They realize Petoskey is at the Mackinac Bridge ("[North South East West](#)"). Meanwhile, Liz revisits her marriage proposal to Petey on a boat under it ("[Natural Beauty](#)").

They drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce, but he tosses it into the water ("[Rock Bottom](#)"). This causes the bridge to fog up where Michilimackinac, the Great Turtle appears. They share that stones are like family as they come and go to leave a mark. And they ask the kids to stop the data centers around Michigan due to its harm on the environment and its noisiness ("[Family's in the Fossils](#)").

They return to the fair where Amanda is exhibiting data center models with the oligarchs. Jasper offers his restaurant for the Lake House. The VanDams return with years of costume while Amanda shows how much "better" AI is. But the town rallies for this creatively weird family, against AI's goal of turning lakes into data centers. Amanda and the crew steal the Ford, causing the town to chase after them. Liz, on her way to the Mackinac Bridge, tricks Amanda's GPS AI to go there. Her trauma causes her to crash off the side of the bridge. Everyone gets off, but the Ford falls into the strait below ("[Leave No Stones Unturned](#)").

It has been years since the death of their loved ones that Liz and Amanda have visited the Mackinac Bridge. In unison, the VanDams and Amanda cross it, where Petey and Conor's ghost have their own reunion as lovers and brothers once more. Amanda cancels her agreement to keep the Lake House and Elk Rapids ("[Water to My Soul](#)").

Years later, Willy passes away. Lulu and Petoskey buy and fix up the lake house. On January 26, 2037, Lansing holds a parade to celebrate the 200th anniversary of MI's statehood with representatives from every city marching. The theme is Pure Michigan. Representing Elk Rapids, the VanDam family resembles the state's best ("[Michigan](#)").

Michigan

CAST OF CHARACTERS

THE VANDAM FAMILY

PETOSKEY VANDAM is a 13-year-old farm boy from Skandia who loves wearing patterns. Besides his mom Liz, his only connection to extended family happens on Harbor Days in Elk Rapids. He never met his late father. To honor Petey, he wears his heart-shaped Petoskey heirloom with an elk symbol.

LIZZIE VANDAM is Petoskey's mother and narrator in Skandia. After her husband Petey's suicide in 2008, she stops crossing the Mackinac Bridge to attend Harbor Days and all family gatherings. Liz is a proud farm girl Yooper. Michigan State.

PETEY VANDAM is Petoskey's father, Liz's husband, and Willy and Milly's only son of four. Every Harbor Days, he would be the first to get up to wake everyone up. During the recession, his blue-collar shipyard job fires and replaces him and Liz with migrants, leading to a fight with his little sister Shelby for marrying an Arab. He drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house with his life insurance. His ghost visits Petoskey whenever he crosses the bridge. Michigan State.

LULU ABUGHOSH is a 13-year-old city girl from Dearborn who loves wearing solid colors, yet she is trollface personified. She hopes to beat cousin Petoskey in their annual rare rocks collection. She is writing a musical titled *Dearborn*, about a family of deer navigating the anthropomorphic Great Lakes. She plays banjo and is Iggy Pop's biggest fan. Her name is Arabic meaning "pearl."

SHELBY ABUGHOSH is Petoskey's aunt, Petey's little sister, and Lulu's mother who lives in Dearborn. She is an automotive worker for Ford Motor Company. As the sister who broke the mold by falling in love with an Arab, she and Petey had a tumultuous relationship. She tries to respect Petoskey. Kettering University.

PERRY VANDAM is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's older sister in Lansing. Her campy mind loves science. Michigan Technological University and Eastern Mich dropout.

CHERRY JACOBOWITZ is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's oldest sister in Kalamazoo. She arranges the theme and costumes for the annual Harbor Days parade. She is married to a Grand Rapids Griffins hockey manager. Hope College.

JACOB JACOBOWITZ is Cherry's son who is a Broadway actor in New York. He is the 2022 Grand Marshal for the Harbor Days Grande Parade where he is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*. He recently performed on the national tour of this show. Western Michigan University.

Michigan

LIBERTY AND BAILEY are twin siblings and Petoskey, Lulu, and Jacob's little cousins removed from reality. They are from Hell... Michigan. Liberty is allergic to sand and Bailey is allergic to pine. They make poison ivy bouquets.

MILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's bold grandmother and inventor. She invented the auto-toilet. With Willy, she owns a house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. She and Willy stumble into the audience every so often. Central Michigan University.

WILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's chill grandfather and gardener. With Milly, he owns a lake house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. Grieving Milly's death in 2020, he leaves the garden unattended and accidentally signs away the deed. He and Milly stumble into the audience every so often. Northern Michigan University.

MICHIGANDERS

JASPER VINH CHIN is Petey's resourceful childhood friend and Petoskey's godfather/godmother who runs the BANH Michigan Vietnamese restaurant and a golf course. As a teen, they once looked down on the Arab community when a Lebanese family bought out his family's previous struggling restaurant. After Petey's death with his last memory being his prejudice towards Arabs for "stealing American jobs," they vow to help migrants no matter what. Ferris State.

AMANDA WAYLAND is the CEO of Turkey Ventures from Muskegon with the goal of turning every lake city into a data center. Following her brother Conor's suicide off the Mackinac Bridge, she loses her creative spirit and takes over her brother's business to create Afterlife.AI to bring late loved ones back as avatars. She was an art school rival of Cherry, before getting expelled. Hope College dropout. University of Michigan.

DETECTIVE is an investigator along the Mackinac Bridge.

THE GHOST OF HENRY FORD returns from Hell.

COPS, OLIGARCHS, RESIDENTS, anyone who speaks in "ope."

THE KEEPERS OF FAITH, FIRE, TRADE are the original people of the land.

MICHILIMACKINAC, the Mackinac spirit resembling the Great Turtle or a giant elk.

Michigan

MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. [Overture / The Mitten Song](#) Petey
2. [Life is Complete](#) Vandams
3. [Body of Water](#) Petey, Lizzie, Detective, Mackinac Ghosts
4. [Yoopers and Trolls](#) Petoskey, Lulu
5. [It Would Be a Shame](#) Amanda, Willy, Milly, Petey
6. [Dad Tax](#) Jasper, Lizzie, Cherry, Perry, Shelby, Lulu, Petoskey, Kids
7. [Dearborn](#) Lulu, Vandams, Deer
8. [Al Does the Work for Me](#) Amanda, Vandams
9. [Wild Midwest](#) Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
10. [Fish for Mom and Dad](#) Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
11. [Time Does Heal](#) Perry, Lulu, Petoskey, Cousins
12. [Gichigamiin \(The Great Lakes Ballet\)](#) Lulu, Keepers, Explorers
13. [The Starving Artist](#) Amanda
14. [Fraudway](#) Vandams
15. [Kick Rocks](#) Vandams, Keepers of Faith Fire Trade

ACT II

16. [Hands Come in Handy](#) Lulu, Petoskey
17. [Petoskey](#) Lizzie, Amanda, Vandams
18. [North South East West](#) Jasper, Lulu, Jacob
19. [Natural Beauty](#) Lizzie, Petey
20. [Rock Bottom](#) Petoskey, Lulu, Jasper, Mackinac Ghosts
21. [Family's in the Fossils](#) Michilimackinac, Petoskey, Lulu
22. [Leave No Stones Unturned](#) Amanda, Vandams, Michiganders
23. [Water to My Soul](#) Lizzie, Petey, Mackinac Ghosts
24. [Michigan](#) Michiganders

MICHIGAN THEMES

[Nayaano](#)

Main Theme

[Pine Monsters](#)

Troublesome Theme

[Water Spirits](#)

Childhood Theme

[Wind Hoppers](#)

Migration Theme

[Lake Giants](#)

Adulthood Theme

[Michilimackinac](#)

Nature Theme

PROLOGUE

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2008 - DAY

1. "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

Next to the shores of Elk Lake,
the VanDam family camps in tents.
The old Lake House is behind them.

PETHEY (30s, adorable man) leaves
his tent. He wears mittens. With a
yawn, he bangs pots and pans.

PETHEY

WAKEY WAKEY, SUN.
LET'S WEAR OUR MITTENS
AND COOK 'EM EGGS WITH LOTSA BACON
FOR OUR GODSEND, MICHIGAN!
SLEPT WELL, HUN...?

LIZZIE (30s, pregnant narrator)
crawls out of Petey's tent, ready
to smack her noisy hubby.

End of "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

2. "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

LIZZIE

THAT'S THE LOVE OF MY LIFE.
BUT EVERY MORNING, HE'S PUBLIC ENEMY NUMBER ONE.

The three VanDam sisters - CHERRY,
PERRY, and SHELBY (pregnant) -
crawl out of their tents.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

TO HIS WIFE, LIZZIE...

PETHEY

AND ONE TWO AND THREE GODDAM SISTERS!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

THE VANDAM SISTERS!

CHERRY

CHERRY!

PERRY

PERRY!

SHELBY

SHELBY!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

WET WILLY!

The Sisters give Bro a wet willy!

PETEEY

Eeeekkkkk!!!

GRANNY MILLY and GRAMPY WILLY roam
in the audience, giving no F&*@s.

WILLY

DID SOMEONE SAY WET WILLY?!

MILLY

OR WET MILLY?

PETEEY, CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

EW... MOM AND DAD, THAT'S GROSS!

WILLY

WHAT?!

MILLY

HUH?!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

GO PUT ON YOUR HEARING AIDS.

Willy-Milly tune their hearing
aids. They frolic in the Audience.

WILLY & MILLY

GREAT!

MILLY

GRAMPY WILLY.
WE'VE GOT COMPANY.

WILLY

GRANNY MILLY.
REAL GOOD COMPANY.

WILLY & MILLY

ISN'T LIFE SOMETHIN'?

MILLY

YOU HAVE COME A LONG WAY, FRIENDS.

WILLY

TO THE GREATEST BAY IN ALL THE GREAT LAKES!

MILLY

BAKED YOUR KIDS FRESH COOKIES,
MAKE YOURSELF COMFY.

Milly hands out cookies. Willy
removes his shoes. The pit pukes.

MILLY (CONT'D)

Ugh! Ya scaring our guests with your clam feet!

WILLY

I've been working out. My legs are made of mussels. M-U-S-S-E-L-S? Get it?

MILLY

Your dad jokes are getting old, Grampy Willy.

WILLY

Not as old as you, Granny Milly...

MILLY

Shush! The guests are gonna think we're Midwest silly instead of normal silly.

PETHEY

Ma! Pa! Who are you talking to???

LIZZIE

You should put ya parents in a retirement h-

WILLY & MILLY

Our hearing aids heard that! Maestro?!
(to the Conductor)

LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR CRAZY FAMILY!

The VanDams put on Red Wings gear.

LIZZIE

Welcome to Harbor Days with the VanDam family!
What's Harbor Days you ask? For four days in August, it's an Elk Rapids tradition. That's all I know. I've gone to these since Petey and I were high school sweethearts. We always tried to go even while tailgating Michigan State...

PETHEY

Go Green!

AUDIENCE MEMBER

Go White!

LIZZIE

...and I still have no clue what Harbor Days is even about.

CHERRY

It's about the parade, sweetheart.

PERRY

Nah, it's about the carnival, yo!

SHELBY

Actually, it's about the fireworks, deary!

WILLY & MILLY

It's about the Lake House.

WILLY

My genius, Milly. She invented the auto-toilet then flushed her money to buy this Lake House.

MILLY

That ain't how you use the expression, sweetie. Well, my creative Willy tends to our garden.

WILLY

Did you put a turtle in the koi pond? That turtle ate all of our koi fish!

CHERRY

It's my son, Jacob. Little teenage rascal...

LIZZIE

She's Petey's oldest sister, Cherry Jacobowitz. Her family's in Kalamazoo. She's a costume designer and her hubby played hockey with the Grand Rapids Griffins.

Cherry points to Kalamazoo using her hand as Michigan.

CHERRY

The only pucks I give is winning the Most Creative Award at the annual Grande Parade.

LIZZIE

Ever since she was little, Cherry would make the family wear elaborate costumes.

CHERRY

2008 is Red Wings's year.

PETHEY

They just beat Pittsburgh Penguins...

SHELBY

...to win the Stanley Cup. Woop!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Let's win that 2008 Most Creative Award!
NO ONE BEATS THE VANDAMS!

LIZZIE

No one beats us like this 2008 recession. Michigan's been hit hard. Budget's tight. The shipyard in Marquette fired me and Petey. We can only hope that we don't lose our house.

Lizzie shows Marquette on her hand.

PERRY

If this scavenger has kept her den, any other coyote can.

LIZZIE

This is Perry. She and Petey, middle children.

PERRY

I'm in the middle of greatness!

LIZZIE

Single. College dropout. Can never hold a job.

PERRY

I've been at Lansing Impression Science Center!

Perry shows Lansing on her hand.

LIZZIE

Welp, she's the smartest person I know.

SHELBY

What does that make me?

LIZZIE

Pregnancy sistahs!

SHELBY

Whoo yeah!

LIZZIE

Shelby, Petey's youngest sister. How's Ford in Dearborn holding up?

Shelby shows Dearborn on her hand.

SHELBY

Assembly line's fine, thanks to my husband. He got his Kurdish friends jobs. Minimum wage, but what more could one ask for in recession times?

PETEEY

Thanks America, letting illegals steal our jobs-

LIZZIE

Petey... Her husband ain't coming to Harbor Days with that attitude of yours.

PETEEY

He married Shelby for citizenship. He'd dump her when he gets the chance.

SHELBY

Immigrants built the coasts, harbors, country.

The Michigan communities from the Amish to Jewish, Christians to Muslims, auto workers to farmers, college sport fans to trade school artisans make themselves known.

MICHIGANDERS

OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE...

LIZZIE

WITHOUT...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)

THE WORLD SITS ON OUR FURNITURE!

PEOPLE CAN GET ANYWHERE WITH OUR CARS!

OUR CHERRY FARMS ARE THE CHERRY ON TOP!

JASPER VINH CHIN (30s, Vietnamese)
opens the BANH MI restaurant.

JASPER

AND LET'S NOT FORGET!

PETHEY

ELK RAPIDS HAS THE BEST
VIETNAMESE RESTAURANT!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

MICHIGAN HAS THE BEST
VIETNAMESE COMMUNITY!

JASPER

IN THE WHOLE WORLD!

MICHIGANDERS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT BANH MI!

JASPER

BANH MIIIIIIIIIIIIICHIGAN!

MICHIGANDERS

SAY THAT AGAIN!

JASPER

BANH MICHIGAN!

BANH Michigan, a Vietnamese family-owned
restaurant in Elk Rapids, Michigan. Home to
Banh Mi Thit or the Nuong, Banh Mi Heo Quay,
Banh Mi Xiu Mai, Banh Mi Ga Nuong, and home to
our latest Detroit-style Banh Mi-

PETHEY

Banh Mi is also what I called home. Jasper!

JASPER

Petey! Happy Harbor Days to you, and Lizzie,
and your soon-to-be baby!

LIZZIE

Got any Banh Mi baby formula?

JASPER

Way ahead of ya!

PETHEY

Come on by the Lake House for o' time sake.

JASPER

Kosher Banh Mi for Cherry's son Jacob and
sourdough for Willy and Milly?

PETHEY

Always able to make Banh Mi for everyone.

JASPER

Cause Banh Mi is you and me!

VANDAMS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT...

PERRY

RIGHT WING RADIO!

PETHEY

Ah, I see...

CHERRY

Outta all of us...

SHELBY

You're coocoo.

PETHEY, CHERRY, SHELBY

What's wrong with you?

PERRY

I'll tell you what's wrong: anything not right.

AMANDA WAYLAND (30s, all business)
gets on stage for an interview.

RADIO (O.S.)

We have a special guest on The Patriot. Amanda
Wayland, CEO of the creative startup, Turkey
Ventures. First, we express our condolences for
your loss.

CHERRY

My art nemesis...

AMANDA

Life's been incomplete without my cofounder.
But we believe what would complete the lives of
many going through grief... and that is AI.

RADIO

(Laughing)

This is 2008. Not 2080. AI is going nowhere.

VANDAMS W/O PERRY

What's so funny? AI...?

PERRY

Artificial intelligence.

CHERRY

Too bad she didn't have art intelligence. She wouldn't been expelled from our art school.

PERRY

Cut her some slack. She lost her cofounder.

CHERRY

I'd cut her if she hadn't stabbed me in the back. Boo hoo, she's going through loss. She didn't need to lose her artistic integrity too.

AMANDA & VANDAMS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITH ENEMIES AND RIVALRIES.

Willy drives in the Ford Model T.

WILLY

AND OUR FORD MODEL T!

MICHIGANDERS

THE FORD MODEL T!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
DADDY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)
WILLY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

WILLY & MILLY

THIS BABY'S JUST A CENTURY YOUNG.

Liz, Petey, Shelby, and Jasper
hang out by Elk Lake.

LIZZIE

Watcha naming your daughter?

SHELBY

Lulu! It means "pearl." And your ibnuki (إبنك)?

Petey looks disgusted.

LIZZIE

Lulu is jameela (جميلة). No clue.

JASPER

I bet Petey's got an ace up his sleeves.

PETEY

More like *stone*.

Petey and Jasper hop into Elk Lake, splashing each other.

PETEY (CONT'D)

We won't name our son. A rock in Elk Lake will!

Petey dives into Elk Lake.

JASPER

Jasper! Jasper! Jasper!

LIZZIE

This gotta be a joke...

Petey resurfaces with a heart-shaped, Elk-marked Petoskey stone.

MICHIGANDERS

(Gospel)

PETOSKEY...

PETOSKEY...

THE JEWEL OF MICHIGAN...

LIZZIE

WE AIN'T NAMING OUR SON THAT.

JASPER

How about naming your second kid, Jasper?!

PETEY

WE DON'T HAVE TO NAME HIM PET-

Liz kisses Petey. They join the rest of the family, marching in the Harbor Days Grande Parade.

LIZZIE

ISN'T LIFE BEAUTIFUL?

PETEY (CONT'D)

ISN'T LIFE WORTH LIVING?

VANDAMS

LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR

MICHIGANDERS

LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH THIS

LIZZIE

CRAZY

PETEY

SASSY

CHERRY

WORKY

PERRY

NERDY

SHELBY

DERPY

WILLY
WILLY

MILLY
LOVELY

JASPER & MICHIGANDERS
WELCOMING...

VANDAMS
FAMILY!

The Michiganders give Milly the
Most Creative Award plaque.

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

Liz's phone rings. She answers.

LIZZIE
No! Please! Life is incomplete without it!

Liz slams her flip phone. She nod
at Petey. He holds her close.

PETHEY
Our house? No no no. Rest assured, all that
matters is that we have our lives ahead.

Liz lets go. She exits with
everyone clearing the parade.

PETHEY (CONT'D)
We ain't losing our house... I've got my life
insurance... Let's trade.

Elk Lake becomes Mackinac Strait.

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - EVENING

3. "BODY OF WATER"

In the foggy storm, Petey ponders.

PETHEY
EVERY LIVING THING IS MADE OF WATER.
EVERY MACHINERY NEEDS THE FLOW OF WATER.
ALL THE WEATHER TAKE THE HEATED WATER.
ALL THE SEASONS BRING THE COOLING WATER.

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD UNLIKE WATER.
I'VE BROUGHT NOTHING TO THE WORLD BUT TEARS!

The MACKINAC GHOSTS manifest,
resembling those who died there.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.

PETHEY

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

CHERISH. CHERISH THIS ONE LIFE.

PETHEY

JUST TEARS!
HELP!

The Ghosts steal Petey's stone.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

HELP? HELL, HELP YOURSELF!

A Motherly Ghost returns with a
Petoskey necklace. Petey wears it.

PETHEY

I CHOOSE LIFE!

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)

TAKE IT IN.

PETHEY (CONT'D)

DRINK THE GREAT LAKES WATER.
THINK PAIN. PAIN YOU'LL CAUSE.
HAPPY WIFE. BABY IN SIGHT. DYING AIN'T RIGHT.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.
CHERISH. CHERISH LIGHT.

PETHEY

HELP MYSELF TO THIS GREAT WATER!

Petey drives the car away.

Emergency vehicles lights beat the
morning Sun. The orchestra wails.

Liz rushes in with the DETECTIVE.
She stops in her tracks, kneeling.

LIZZIE

LIFE IS A COMPLETE... DISASTER...
LIFE IS INCOMPLETE WITHOUT PETE-

DETECTIVE

WE ARE SORRY TO REPORT THE CAR SUBMERGED UNDER MACKINAC
BRIDGE IS IDENTIFIED AS YOURS...

LIZZIE

AND...?

DETECTIVE

NO BODIES.
NOBODY.

The Detective hands the Petoskey necklace to Liz, then leaves.

LIZZIE

NOBODY LOVES ME LIKE THIS BODY OF WATER...

Petey manifests.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)

NOBODY...

LIZZIE

WITH MY LAST TEAR, I'M OUT OF WATER IN MY HEART.

PETHEY

YOU ARE MY SOUL.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)

NOBODY...

Petey closes Liz's hand, sealing the Petoskey. Then, he vanishes.

End of "BODY OF WATER"

LIZZIE

Bridges are supposed to unite lands, not divide souls. Our house has been spared thanks to my hubby's life insurance. But I didn't mind losing *what* is called home when it meant losing *who* I called home. I just wanna sink like a rock-

Shelby, bruised up, enters and embraces Liz on the ground.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Every rock has a soft spot, like my son...

Liz places the Petoskey necklace down (now called the "Heirloom").

Shelby helps the grieving Liz exit.

END OF PROLOGUE

ACT I

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2019 - DAY

4. "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

PETOSKEY (11, farm boy in a flat hat) crawls out of his tent. He puts on the Heirloom and mittens. He bangs pots and pans.

LULU (11, city gal in a headscarf) crawls out of her tent and trolls.

LULU
...Petoskey!

PETOSKEY
Lulu!

LULU
Shut up, Yooper!

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Pipe down, Troll!

Cherry, Perry, and Shelby enter.

CHERRY
Kids at it again?

SHELBY
With my daughter, you betcha.

PERRY
Let's be responsible... and place some bets.

SHELBY
Let's go Lulu! Your inheritance in on the line!

PETOSKEY
HOLY WAH! ANOTHER DAY TO GO FISHING!

LULU
YEAH NO... TODAY, WE GO BIRD WATCHING.

PETOSKEY
AREN'T YOU FROM EH... DEARBORN?

LULU
I AIN'T INTO DEER, YOU WILD YOOPERS...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN.
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

LULU
HOLY CRAP, I HATE *HATE* CAMPING WITH YOU.

PETOSKEY
NO ONE LIKES YOUR HIP HOP TRASH.

LULU
TAKE IT BACK, COUNTRY BOY.

PETOSKEY
YOU FIRST, CITY GAL.

LULU & PETOSKEY
ANOTHER HARBOR DAYS...

LULU
...WITH THIS WILD YOOOPER...

Lulu and Petoskey wrestle.

PETOSKEY
STAY UNDER THE BRIDGE, TROLL!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOOPERS AND TROLLS FORM A BRIDGE!

WILLY & MILLY
STOP FIGHTING!

End of "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
Not a Harbor Days go by where my rock and his
pearly cousin aren't fighting. The whole
family's weird. There's cousin Jacob Jacobowitz
who is making it on Broadway. Then Liberty and
Bailey. Twin cousins from Hell... Michigan. My
in-laws say they're angels.

Liberty and Bailey go buck wild
and chase everyone around.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
I don't remember the other cousins Petoskey
mentioned. They got many cousins, aunts, uncles-
I wish I could meet them all but Mackinac. A
bridge I cannot cross. Its watery depths
crossed my heart and made many hope to die.

Cherry drives in. Petoskey sits.
Then Perry takes over and gives
him homework. Then Shelby and Lulu
shove Perry and Petoskey out. Then
Granny Milly respectfully takes
over and lets him in the car.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Fortunately, my son is able to. His aunties have no problem taking turns driving him from the U P to the L P. After Harbor Days, Granny Milly drives him home or insane. He is said to hear a man's voice whenever they cross-

As Petoskey naps in the car, he awakens to Petey's song.

PETEY (V.O.)

WAKEY WAKEY, SON...

Jasper takes over for Milly. He drops off Petoskey in Skandia. Liz sees Jasper become his godfather.

LIZZIE

Whenever Milly wasn't feeling well, Petoskey was Jasper's problem.

Then the real problem came in 2020. We didn't see it coming. Granny Milly, her genius mind, and flawless cookies were suddenly gone. Grampy Willy canceled family reunions in 2020 to 2021. He needed to grieve alone. I worry for him and the Lake House. I'm thankful for our home, living off hubby's life insurance. But I cannot be sure Grampy Willy will be around much longer.

Petoskey looks at photos of Milly.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Son, I know how much Grammy Milly meant to you. So, would it mean the world if I went to this year's Harbor Days? August two ol' two two.

PETOSKEY

You'd cross the bridge?

LIZZIE

Nah. We'll take the long way through Wisconsin.

PETOSKEY

That's not fair! Everyone's cheesy there...

LIZZIE

Let's get a MOOooooove on. For Milly's sake.

Liz and Petoskey exit.

SCENE 2

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AUGUST 2022 - DAY

5. "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

Willy stares longingly at a photo of his late wife Milly.

Amanda knocks on the door. Willy goes open it, then slams it.

AMANDA
I NEED YOUR LAKE HOUSE!

WILLY
YOU DAMN VULTURE.

MILLY (V.O.)
WHO ARE YOU CALLING A VULTURE?

Willy opens the door again. Amanda nabs Milly's photo and sets it on her tablet.

AMANDA
AND YOU NEED YOUR WIFE BACK.
MY NAME'S AMANDA WAYLAND OF TURKEY VENTURES...
AND I CAN BRING YOUR WIFE TO LIFE!

WILLY
SHE DID NOT BELIEVE IN ALCHEMY.

AMANDA
THIS IS NOT ALCHEMY.
IT IS TECHNOLOGY!

Milly shows up behind Amanda.

MILLY
SO PROUD OF YOU.

AMANDA
(Raising the tablet volume)
YOU HEARD THAT?

MILLY
I LOVE YOU!!

AMANDA
I'D LOVE FOR YOU TO LET ME BUILD A DATA CENTER BY YOUR LAKE.
SO, SHE CAN GET THE WATER SHE NEEDS.

MILLY
DO NOT BRING SHAME.

Willy looks at the disapproving Violinists in the orchestra.

AMANDA
DON'T BE ASHAMED TO SAY "NO."

WILLY
NO.

Milly disappears.

Amanda expects it. She "respects"
his choice. Before going, she nabs
a photo. Outside, she sets it on
her tablet. Petey enters the home.

PETEEY
WASN'T MY LIFE WORTH MORE THAN MY HOUSE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEEY
WASN'T MY BREATH WORTH MORE THAN SOME LAKE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEEY
WASN'T MY HEART WORTH MORE THAN THESE ROCKS?

WILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME IN FORGETTING THEM.

Milly joins Petey.

PETEEY, MILLY, AMANDA
SHAME...
SHAME...
ASHAMED...
ONLY SHAME...
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I CHOSE THE HOUSE BEFORE MY FAMILY!
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I MAKE...

AMANDA
BRING BACK YOUR WIFE!

PETEEY & MILLY
DON'T BE ASHAMED!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE...

PETEEY & MILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME.

AMANDA
BRING BACK YOUR SON!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME...

PETHEY, MILLY, AMANDA
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY	AMANDA
IT'D BE SHAME IF I MAKE THE	IT'D BE A SHAME IF YOU MADE
SAME MISTAKE...	THE SAME...

PETHEY, MILLY, AMANDA
IT'D BE A SHAME!

Milly and Petey vanish before
Willy hugs them. Instead, he holds
a tablet, displaying a contract.

End of "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

SCENE 3

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - DAY

6. "DAD TAX"

Jasper finishes setting up the
tents for these useless Kids.

Shelby and Lizzie stare in awe as
Lulu and Petoskey feel awful.

SHELBY
Thanks for everything, Jasper.

LULU
I really did not need your help.

PETOSKEY
You needed all the help you can get, Lulu.

JASPER
And you needed manpower.

LULU
Ha! He called you a sissy, Petoskey!

LIZZIE
How could we ever repay you?

JASPER
Your sweetness is good 'nough for me.

Jasper nabs a handful of candy
from Lulu and Petoskey's box.

LULU & PETOSKEY
That's *my* candy.

Lulu and Petoskey stare down one
another as they fight for the box.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Mine! My sweets! Sugar! Mine!

LIZZIE
I'll let you take it from here.

Liz fist bumps Shelby and Cherry,
then leaves the premises.

Jasper takes their box away.

JASPER
In the jurisdiction vested by the council of
fathers and godfathers, everything is mine.

LULU & PETOSKEY
What jurisdiction?

Jasper pulls out the "Dad Rules!"
book. They open it for the kids to
skim, then they promptly close it.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY UP!
PAY DOWN!
PAY UP!
PAY DOWN!

JASPER
YOU KIDS GOT NO SAY...

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
SO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION?

JASPER
IT'S GOOD FOR THE COMMUNITY!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
THAT'S WHAT A COMMUNIST WOULD SAY!

JASPER
JUST PAY YOUR FAIR SHARE!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NEVER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

DAD RULES!
TAX SEASON!
CAMP REASONS!
COME COLLECT.
PAY DOWN YOUR DEBT.

Jasper and the Aunties collect.

AUNTIES
(in unison)
YOUR COOKIES!
YOUR CANDIES!
YOUR FRENCH FRIES!
YOUR MILK SHAKES!
YOUR CHICKEN!
YOUR NUGGETS!
YOUR KID'S MEALS!
YOUR ROBLOX!
YOUR MINECRAFT!
YOUR FREEDOM!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
(as individuals)
MY COOKIES!
MY CANDY!
MY FRENCH FRIES!
MY MILK SHAKE!
MY CHICKEN!
MY NUGGETS!
MY KID'S MEAL!
MY ROBLOX!
MY MINECRAFT!
OUR CIVIL LIBERTIES!

JASPER
YOU'VE GOT TRANSPORTATION...
DRINKING WATER...

Jasper drinks the milk shakes.

JASPER (CONT'D)
THERE'RE NOW CAMP GOODS AND SERVICES...
ALL THANKS TO THE DAD TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY YOUR DAD TAX!

Jasper nervously hides, hearing
Liz's footsteps. He can't breathe.

JASPER
I need to collect dad tax because I owe...

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
Owe what????!!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
THE...

Like the Queen, Liz royally makes
an entrance. Jasper grovels like a
peasant.

LIZZIE
MOM TAX! I'LL TAKE EVERYTHING!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
EVERYTHING?!

JASPER
NOTHING'S OFF THE TABLE!

The Aunties remove a table.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
EVEN THE TABLE?!

JASPER
NO ONE CAN STOP HER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
NO ONE!

LIZZIE
NO ONE CAN STOP THE MOM TAX!

Liz starts a campfire using the
wood from the table.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
SHE'S ON FIRE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
SHE'LL TAKE ANYTHING!

LIZZIE
CASH AND CREDIT!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
EVERYTHING'S
OURS OURS OURS OURS.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
OURS OURS
OURS OURS.

Liz and the Aunties down insane
amounts of candy. Their focus
suddenly shifts to the Audience.
They prepare to pounce.

JASPER
OH NO, Y'ALL COOKED.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
OH NO, WE'RE COOKED.

Lulu retreats into her tent.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
THE...

LIZZIE
THEATRE TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
...THEATRE TAX!

Liz and the Aunties run into the
Audience and tax them for
everything and anything!

JASPER
TAX THE AUDIENCES!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NOT THE AUDIENCES!

LIZZIE

ATTENTION!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
WE'LL TAKE EVERYONE!

LIZZIE
GIVE ME YOUR TIX! TIX! TIX! TIX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
OURS OURS OURS OURS...

JASPER
EVERYTHING'S...

JASPER (CONT'D)
(Repeating)
TAX! TAX! TAX! TAX!

LIZZIE
(Repeating)
TIX! TIX! TIX! TIX!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
(Repeating)
MOM?! MOM?! MOM?! MOM?!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
(Repeating)
OURS OURS OURS OURS!

LIZZIE
SUGAR CRASH...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
MINE! MINE! MINE! MINE! MINE!

JASPER
SHE'LL TAKE ALL, ESPECIALLY TIME!

LIZZIE
I'VE COME TO COLLECT YOUR DAD TAX!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
LET'S TAKE EVERYTHING!

Liz and the Aunties down the rest
of the candy! (o_©)

End of "DAD TAX"

They gather by the campfire.

JASPER
A perfect campfire to honor Grammy Milly, all
on the taxpayers' expense. Lemme go get Grampy
Willy.

Jasper goes into the Lake House.

SHELBY

Lemme get Lulu...

Shelby goes to Lulu's tent alone.

SHELBY (CONT'D)

Dearest Lulu, everyone's waiting for you.

LULU

Where?

SHELBY

By the bonfire.

LULU

That can wait. I've got a musical to finish!

SHELBY

And you think staying in tents like your room
fills you with inspiration?

LULU

I need to finish my musical before school
starts at the end of the month.

SHELBY

You can't write on empty eyes.

LULU

Don't you mean stomach?

SHELBY

You can't write without *fire in your eyes*.

7. "DEARBORN"

Lulu stays hiding in her tent.

LULU

OOO... OOO... OOO... OOO... OOO...

Lulu hops out of her tent with her
Banjo.

LULU (CONT'D)

DEAREST LULU!

DEARBORN REPRESENT!

I DON'T KNOW WHY TIME
HAS NEVER MOVED FORWARD
EV' SINCE I WAS BORN
EV' SINCE I COULD RHYME!
I CANNOT FIND THAT STATE OF MIND.
SIGH...
SO HELP ME,
MY DEAREST.

I HAVE BEEN IN TUNE
TO EARTH AND HER SPIRITS
THE DAY MOM GAVE BIRTH
'TIL I'M A TOMB.
BURY MY HEART, SO SHE'D BLOOM.
OOO... OOO... RAISE ME.
OH DEAREST.
DEARBORN.

Lulu shows off her theatre fandom.

LULU (CONT'D)
I HAVE DREAMT COUNTLESS FABLES SET TO MUSICALS!
HOW OH HOW CAN I NOT WRITE PAST "DEAR?"
MY LYRICS LACK SOUL, LOSING HER SENSE OF DIRECTION.
SPIRITUAL CONNECTIONS.
DEAR ME: WHY CAN'T I LOCK IN?
DEARBORN WRITER'S BLOCK!

In Lulu's head, the rest of the
VanDams answer her question.

VANDAMS

DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE A LOSAH!
A LOONEY LOSER!

LULU	VANDAMS (CONT'D)
NOTE TO SELF: IT'S BECAUSE	LOO... LOO...
YOUR FAMILY HATES YOU, LU...	LOSER...

Lulu runs away from the family.
She stops herself in the middle of
a dirt road.

LULU (CONT'D)
NO LONGER IN TUNE
TO EARTH AND HIS DEMONS.
I WISH MOM AIN'T BIRTH ME.
SEE YOU IN A TOMB.
BURY MY HEART FOR SHE'S DOOMED.
OOO... DON'T SAVE ME.
DON'T DEARY...

A car's headlights approaches.
Before it can hit her, a DEER
stands in its way and stops it.

LULU (CONT'D)
Ah deer...

More Deer join the first Deer.

LULU (CONT'D)
Oh deers!

DEER

The plural form is still "deer," dear.

DEER (CONT'D)

Why are you in the middle of the road?

LULU

My life's a dead end. Why are you protecting me, deer...ssss...?

DEER

Who exactly are we protecting?

LULU

NAME'S LULU...

LULU (CONT'D)

I'M A LOSER.
A LOONEY LOSER.
HUH?

DEER

A LOOSE CANNON
WITH NOTHING TO LOSE.

DEER (CONT'D)

DEARBORN.
YOU'RE MEANT TO GO BUCK WILD!
BUT WERE MADE SHY.
WHY OH WHY AIN'T YA BORN A
DEER FACING SPOTLIGHT, BENT, AGILE, A RESPECTABLE ROLE.
MOTHER NATURE'S SOULS.

LULU

OOO... OOO... OOO...
DEAR ME: NOW I WANNA START WRITING MUSICALS ABOUT DEER?

The Deer lead Lulu back to the
bonfire.

DEER

DEARY... OOO...
DEAREST LULU,
PLEASE CHOOSE YOUR MUSE, SPIRIT, LU...
DON'T LOSE TO THESE LOSERS.
GOT THAT, LULU?
LULU?

LULU

I WANNA WIN EVERYONE'S HEARTS WITH OR WITHOUT MY ART!
CAN AH CAN I MAKE MY "I WANT" SONG CLEARER?
I WANNA WIN RESPECT BY ANY MEANS!
EVENING GETTING MEAN!
DEAR ME:
WHAT WILL I BRING BEING DEARBORN DEARBORN!

The VanDams gather, unknowing that
a family of Deer lurks nearby.

LULU (CONT'D)

DEAR LULU... YES, YOU!
YOU YOU YOU YOU YOU. YOU'RE...
DEARBORN. DEARBORN. YOU ARE DEAREST BORN...

VANDAMS

DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE A LOSAH!
A LOONEY LOSER!
LOO... LOO...
LOSER...

DEER

DEAREST LULU,
THE LOOSE CANNON WITH NOTHING TO LOSE.
LULU... LULU... LULU...

The VanDams heighten the bonfire,
scaring off the Deer family.

End of "DEARBORN"

TWINS

So some deers saved you when you ran off?

LULU

Plural of "deer" is still "deer." Yes, dear.

PETOSKEY

Lulu, you are a loooosssseeeeerrrr.

Lulu lowers her banjo in defeat.

JACOB

Shut up, Petoskey! Lulu, you had nothing to
lose, telling us such wild story. That's a
Dearborn song if I say so myself. Can't wait to
see the full musical. Now, anything you'd like
to share, Petoskey, while we still wait on-

Jasper enters with Willy. He pulls
up a chair.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Took you hours.

JASPER

Willy kept talking to Henry Ford's ghost.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Not again. Henry Ford, ugh...

Willy sits. Everyone sits down.

CHERRY

We gather here today to remember Grammy Milly.
It's been a couple years since she left this
world...

WILLY

Actually, Milly came back a couple days ago.

Everyone stares at Willy like an
old man who lost his marbles.

PERRY

In what world?

SHELBY

It's time to put you in a nursing home.

Willy pulls out a tablet.

WILLY

Home is in here.

CHERRY

Dad, you can't just call the after life.

WILLY

Milly, please call.

Milly appears on the tablet,
disturbing everyone.

MILLY

Way ahead of you.

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

She looks so real!

WILLY

She is.

PERRY

No, she's not.

CHERRY

She... Don't break dad's heart again.

WILLY

You all have seen enough of your mama. I can
ask Petey to call.

Liz covers Petoskey's eyes.

LIZZIE

No no no.

JASPER

What did this cost?

WILLY

It doesn't matter.

CHERRY

How much?

WILLY

My son was worth more than...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

...the house...?!

Amanda slyly steps in.

AMANDA

Yes, access to Afterlife dot AI was on the house. I see it's a perfect time to come in when everyone seems fired up. Cherry.

CHERRY

Amanda...

AMANDA

How's making 'em kiddy costumes for your dumb Harbor Days parade?

CHERRY

How's making anything? That's right. You can't.

LULU

Who's she?

PERRY

Amanda Wayland was Cherry's classmate in Hope College art school.

CHERRY

Until she was caught cheating with Photoshop.

AMANDA

And now everyone's using Photoshop.

SHELBY

Don't you use that, Cherry?

CHERRY

Shut up. I use Corel.

PERRY

You geezer. Who uses Corel?

AMANDA

And I did complete my degree at U of M.

VANDAMS

Ew... The Wolverines.

KIDS

Rabies...

AMANDA

Bite me. Now, everyone around the world depends on me to get through the day, answer questions smart or dumb, read novels, write essays, entire musicals-

LULU & JACOB

You monster!

AMANDA

I didn't get to the best part. It does the impossible. It brings the dead to life.

CHERRY

Get out.

AMANDA

You're impressed.

PERRY

Depressed. Seriously, get out.

SHELBY

Vamos!

JASPER

Willy, implore this morally ambiguous woman to leave the premises.

AMANDA

The premise is... I own your Lake House. There's a Willy, there's a way. Willy, thanks for not making the same mistake your son made.

CHERRY

To maintain the premises...

8. "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Who will do the hard work?

AMANDA

A I!!!

Amanda releases a bunch of physical embodiments of AI slop.

VANDAMS

A I? R U CRAZY!

AMANDA

LISTEN, FREAKS.
I'M NOT YOUR ENEMY!

AMANDA (CONT'D)

DON'T MISS THIS GREAT OPPORTUNITY!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY

IT'S FREE?

AMANDA

SO FREE.

CHERRY

THIS IS SLAVERY.

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY

REALLY?

AMANDA

BUT DIRT CHEAP!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY

LET'S CHEAT!

CHERRY

THE BILL FOR ELECTRICITY?

AMANDA

SPEAKING OF CITY!

EVERY CITY WITH A DATA CENTER HAS INTERNET FASTER THAN LIGHT!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY

LIGHT?!

AMANDA

EVERY HOSPITAL RUN BY DATA CENTERS SENDS PATIENTS AWAY FROM
THE LIGHT.

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY

LIGHT?

AMANDA

ANY ORDINARY JOE WILL CENTER DATA FROM GOD'S ENLIGHTENMENT.

VANDAMS

LIGHT.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

CAN DATA CENTERS MAKE MEMES?!

AMANDA

AI'S DOING THE WORK WITH MEMES!
YOU'D GET COMEDY LETTING IT MAKE MEMES OF YOUR FAMILY!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY
WHAT ABOUT MONEY?

AMANDA
OH, AI'S DOING THE WORK FOR FREE!
YOU'LL GROW WEALTHY LETTING IT DAY TRADE IN YOUR
CRYPTOCURRENCIES!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY
WILL IT GROW A CONSCIENCE?

AMANDA
AI WILL UNDERSTAND CONSCIOUSNESS...

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY
MEMES?

AMANDA
...FOR US!

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY
MONEY?

AMANDA
FOR ME...

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY
CONSCIENCE?

Amanda displays her tablet with a
picture of her late brother Conor,
1984-esque.

AMANDA
FOR MY CONOR!

CHERRY
YOUR BROTHER?

VANDAMS
BIG BROTHER...

AMANDA
AI'S DOING THE WORK FOR ME!
I'LL MAKE HISTORY WITH DATA CENTERS IN ALL CITIES!
AI MAY GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF US WILL REALIZE...
OH WELL...

AI'S GONNA MAKE ME LOTSA MONEY!
THAT'S THE MYSTERY OF DATA CENTERS IN YOUR CITIES!
MAYBE I WILL GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF YOU SPREAD
LIES...
NO WAY...
AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME!

End of "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

PETOSKEY
Wow... Yas, Kween!

Jacob slaps Petoskey's shoulder.

JACOB

Don't say "Kween" in a straight way ever again.

AMANDA

As your "Kween," I am entitled to a tour of your shanty palace.

Cherry is about to lead Amanda.

AMANDA (CONT'D)

No no no. I only give access to those who showed some respect around here. Crystal?

PETOSKEY

Petoskey.

AMANDA

Okay. Pebble.

PETOSKEY

May I bring my mom?

Petoskey and Liz lead Amanda into the Lake House.

SCENE 6

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - EVENING

The walls are full of photos.

Petoskey and Liz guide Amanda around the Lake House.

AMANDA

My guys will help preserve these photos. Don't you worry about it.

LIZZIE

You'll give them back, right?

AMANDA

No. And the digital prints will be behind a paywall.

PETOSKEY

What's a paywall?

LIZZIE

It's the reason so many people in this state get their news from online conspiracy theorists instead of reading *Detroit Free Press* or *MLive*.

8A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

AMANDA

What's that?

LIZZIE

I thought you're the know-all of capitalism.

Amanda points at a photo of young
Petoskey wearing the Heirloom: a
heart-shaped Petoskey stone with a
marking of an Elk.

AMANDA

No... That.

LIZZIE

It's my late husband's Heirloom.

PETOSKEY

It's what I'm named after.

AMANDA

You outgrew it? Well, no one outgrows cool
rocks, especially a Petoskey. This one seems
like it's worth a whole Great Lake. No... It's
an heirloom. Your dead husband makes this worth
two Great Lakes. Unlike him, is it here?

CHERRY & PERRY

Somewhere...

PETOSKEY

Grammy Milly gave it to me. It's her last gift.

AMANDA

How about a trade?

PETOSKEY

The house...

AMANDA

...for your cool rock. Well, produce it.

PETOSKEY

I wanna put on a show. I need a whole day.

AMANDA

After the Grande Parade?

LIZZIE

After the Grande Parade.

AMANDA

Life will be complete with this cool rock.

Amanda departs.

LIZZIE

And the Lake House under Grampy Willy.

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

PETOSKEY

The Heirloom is the bottom of Pine River...

LIZZIE

You said you let Lulu borrow it?! Wait, when did you go to Pine River? It the fastest rapids in the state. It's dangerous and forbidden! Only Petey and I- Some have canoed there, like Jacob when he was Cherry's teenager...

PETOSKEY

Well three years ago, Jacob took us on a little detour...

SCENE 4

EXT. LUMBERJACK PARK - AUGUST 2019 - DAY (3 YEARS AGO)

9. "WILD MIDWEST"

Jacob paces like a sergeant as his cousins stand in formation.

JACOB

You all are not supposed to be here, but here we are now. All thanks to?

COUSINS

Our favorite cousin Jacob...

JACOB

Favorite?

COUSINS

The famous actor Jacob Jacobowitz...

JACOB

These rapids are not an act. Uncle Petey used to take us canoeing. So blessed to keep this tradition alive. So, shhhhh. Tell your parents and ya dead meat.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

It's not the rapids that'll kill you.

BAILEY

It's the pine!

LIBERTY

Or the sand!

JACOB

You two will be death of me...

Anywho, each canoe needs two rowers. I'll pair you all by ages. Liberty, Bailey, no clue how old y'all are. Lulu, Petoskey, you're both ten-

Jacob pairs up each cousins.

Lulu mockingly sticks her tongue out at Petoskey.

Each team carry in their canoe.

Jacob hands out the paddles.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Here are your paddles. Now each duo must decide their bow and stern.

LULU

Isn't the stern lotsa work?

JACOB

Affirmative.

LULU & PETOSKEY

I choose the bow! No, you're stern! You lazy good for nothin'-

LULU

Whoever gets soaked first...

PETOSKEY

...has to row these rapids...

JACOB

We've got ourselves a WILD MIDWEST SHOWDOWN!

Lulu and Petoskey walk in opposite directions before turning to face each other. They prepare to draw their water guns.

The Twins leap out and startle Lulu. She sprays them while Petoskey unloads on her.

Lulu lies on the ground, defeated.

PETOSKEY

Get paddling! What? I promised the twins from Hell I'd cover their dad tax for the rest of Harbor Days.

LULU

You're gonna sink, Petoskey...

End of "WILD MIDWEST"

SCENE 5

EXT. PINE RIVER - AUGUST 2019 - DAY (3 YEARS AGO)

Jacob rows on his kayak, leading the canoes downstream. Each canoe is occupied by Lulu and Petoskey, Liberty and Bailey, and others.

JACOB

Our first rapids is dead ahead! Make sure you don't stick the paddles in the sharp rocks.

Lulu sticks a paddle in Petoskey.

LULU

Ya ain't sharp, Petoskey.

PETOSKEY

Forget the water guns. You're getting waterboarded, Lulu.

LULU

Woah! That's messed up, war-crimes boy!

The group brushes past the rapids easily. A pine tree overhead brushes against Bailey.

BAILEY

Ah! Ah! Pineee!!!

Bailey collapses in the canoe.

LIBERTY

Twin down! Twin down! We gotta ground!

JACOB

What?! What is it?!

As the canoe stops, Liberty touches the sandy ground.

LIBERTY

Ah! Ah! Sandddd!!!

Liberty convulses by the dune.

Jacob docks and tends to Liberty.

JACOB

You didn't tell us you're really allergic to uh-

LIBERTY

Sand!

BAILEY

Pine!

JACOB

Pine?! Sand?! That's basically Michigan!

JACOB (CONT'D)

Lulu, Petoskey, you go on ahead.

Liberty and Bailey go dead.

JACOB (CONT'D)

(Crying)

Kill two birds with pine and sand. Stop playing dead!

The Twins sit up spontaneously,
holding up poison ivy bouquets.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Poison ivy bouquets?

JACOB

Oh Godddd!!!

LIBERTY & BAILEY

The twins from Hell strike again!

Jacob itches his face to no ends.
He runs off as the Twins and other
Cousins follow him out.

Lulu and Petoskey separate from
the group.

LULU

There is fishiness afoot.

A parent or a couple with their
child or children walk along the
river with their fishing gears.

Petoskey looks longingly at them.

Fishes swim by in the river.

10. "FISH FOR MOM AND DAD"

LULU
IF YOU CAN CATCH...

PETOSKEY
AND RELEASE...

LULU
ANYTHING...

PETOSKEY
IN THE WORLD?

Lulu grabs a fishing hook from out
of nowhere and holds it up to
Petoskey.

LULU
I'M GONNA HOOK YOUR MOUTH IF YOU KEEP INTERRUPTING ME.
WHAT WOULD THEY BE?

PETOSKEY
WHO COULD THEY BE?

Lulu grabs a Bass from the river.

LULU
ARE YOU FISHING FOR THE ANSWER?

BASS
LET'S FISH FOR AN ANSWER.

LULU
Dang! This fish has range!

PETOSKEY
Drop the bass!

Lulu drops the Bass. The Bassist
puts on a fish mask. The fishes
leap out and lay down the beat on
the surface tension of the river.

FISHES
I WANNA GO CAMPING!
I WANNA GO HUNTING!
I WANNA GO FISHING!
YOU NEED A CAMP BUDDY.
YOU NEED A HUNTING MENTOR.

Lulu tunes her banjo.

2003 Liz and Petey canoe besides
2019 Lulu and Petoskey. Liz is the
bow while Petey is the stern.

FISHES (CONT'D)
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...

PETOSKEY
MY FATHER'S SOUL.
MY MOTHER'S WOES.
MAMA BEING CAREFREE.
PAPA BEING WITTY.
MOM AS A NEWLY WED.
DAD FROM HIS DEATHBED.

Lulu and the Fishes pause, looking surprised.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
I SAID WHAT I SAID.

The rest of the Cousins catch up to Lulu and Petoskey. Poison ivy covers Jacob's body. They perform a fatherly and woodcraft dance.

Petoskey gets his fishing pole and extends it to Petey's canoe.

Petey accepts Petoskey's fishing pole and reels himself in.

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO CAMPING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO CAMPING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO HUNTING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO HUNTING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO FISHING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO FISHING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
I'LL BE YOUR CAMP BUDDY!

FISHES
YOU NEED A CAMP BUDDY.

PETOSKEY
ALL I NEED IS MY DAD.

LULU & COUSINS
I'LL TRY HUNTING, I GUESS.

FISHES
YOU NEED A HUNTING MENTOR.

PETOSKEY
ALL I WANT IS A DAD.

LULU & COUSINS
THERE IS A CATCH...

FISHES
YOU NEED TO CATCH...

Petoskey holds up the Heirloom for
Petey and Liz to bear witness.

PETOSKEY
MY FATHER'S SOUL!

LULU & COUSINS
AND RELEASE!

FISHES
AND RELEASE!

End of "FISH FOR MOM AND DAD"

Everyone approaches the rapids.

PETEY
WAKEY, WAKEY, SON...

LULU
Wake up, dum dum! We're heading towards the last
rapids-

Lulu hits Petoskey with the paddle
which causes the canoe to capsize.

Underwater, Petoskey loses grip of
Petey, now gone. He realizes the
Heirloom is missing from his neck.

SCENE 6

EXT. PINE RIVER - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

Present-day Liz grabs Petoskey
from the water.

LIZZIE
Found your rock, yet?

PETOSKEY
I swear dad was here. I mean *the Petoskey*.

LIZZIE
Liberty, Bailey, getting warmer?

BAILEY
(Smirking)
The water is warmer here...

LIBERTY
Ew...

PETOSKEY
Those two are seriously from Hell.

LIZZIE

They're such sweet angels for tagging along and trying to help you find a necklace you lost three years ago...

PETOSKEY

I promised they can pick my costume for next year if they found it.

LIZZIE

What do they want you to wear?

PETOSKEY

Welp, I'd be lucky if I wear clothes.

Lulu shows up.

LULU

Mom told me I should help...

PETOSKEY

Wanna help me lose something else?

LULU

Nah, bruh. I'm deciding what you'll wear next Harbor Days! The Sun is directly above us. It won't be dark until...

The Sun falls out of the sky. The Moon instantly replaces her.

SCENE 7

EXT. SLEEPING BEAR DUNES - NIGHT

A bonfire lives by Lulu, Petoskey, and the rest of the VanDams.

LULU

No time...

PETOSKEY

No rocks... No father... No sorrys...

They all get some rest.

10A. "DEARBORN - REPRISE"

While in her sleeping bag, Lulu sees a Deer pass by.

LULU

(Quietly)

DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE NO LOSER!
A ROCKY LOSER!

YOU'LL... FIND...
PETOSKEY...

Lulu dozes off.

End of "DEARBORN - REPRISE"

SCENE 8

EXT. LAKE MICHIGAN SHORES - MORNING

11. "TIME DOES HEAL"

Perry make some noise to wake up
Lulu, Petoskey, and other Cousins.
She pulls all of them down to the
shore for a quick science lesson.

PERRY
SCIENCE NEVER ENDS!

COUSINS
SCIENCE NEVER ENDS!

PERRY
SCIENCE IS YOUR BEST FRIEND!

COUSINS
SCIENCE IS OUR BEST FRIEND!

Perry pulls out a Fossil and goes
to the Audience.

PERRY
CAN ANYONE TELL ME WHAT THIS IS?
CAN YOU TELL ME WHAT THIS IS?
WHAT IS IT?
THAT'S RIGHT, A FOSSIL!

YOU KNOW WHAT THEY SAY?!

COUSINS
WHAT?!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE HERE TO STAY!

FOSSILS ARE NATURE'S TIME CAPSULE.

COUSINS
HOW MANY YEARS?

PERRY
THOUSANDS, MILLIONS OF YEARS!

COUSINS
A LONG TIME!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE NATURE'S FIRST LESSON.

COUSINS
WHAT DO THEY TEACH?

PERRY
THAT TIME DOES HEAL.

COUSINS
HEAL.

PERRY & COUSINS
WE'LL ALL LEARN TO HEAL.

LULU
DO FOSSILS HAVE FEELINGS?

PERRY
FOSSILS DO HOLD MEMORIES.

COUSINS
WHAT DO THEY REMEMBER?

PERRY
BODY, DIET, HISTORY.

PERRY & COUSINS
FOSSILS HAVE A STORY TO SHARE.

PERRY
STARE AT IT LONG AND YOU WILL SEE.
FOSSILS HAVE ALL SORTS OF HISTORY.

PETOSKEY
DON'T FOSSILS REMIND US WE'LL BE HISTORY?

PERRY
I KNOW HOW YOU FEEL...
FOSSILS COME HERE TO HEAL
BECAUSE...

PERRY & COUSINS
FOSSILS ARE HERE TO STAY!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE SPLIT INTO TWO MAIN GROUPS!

The Cousins hold up dinosaur bones
and footprints.

COUSINS
TRACE AND BODY!

PERRY
FOOTPRINT FOSSILS ARE DIFFERENT FROM BONES!

COUSINS
DINOSAURS!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE NATURE'S REMINDER!

COUSINS
AND THAT IS TIME...

PERRY
THAT TIME DOES HEAL.

COUSINS
HEAL.

PERRY & COUSINS
WE'LL ALL LEARN TO HEAL.
FOSSILS HELP US HEAL.

Perry gives fossils to everyone.

End of "TIME DOES HEAL"

12. "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Lulu trails off from the group, looking at her fossil. As she walks along the coastline of the fourth wall, the Deer approaches from the Audience. They startle her. She uses the fossil as a shield. The Deer snatches her fossil away then drop off the Heirloom and other special rocks. She stares at the rock deposit.

MAGTOGOEK (THE WALKING PATH)

First, Lulu feels a glacial rock. The history of the Great Lakes courses through her. She floats from the Atlantic Ocean into the mainland on St. Lawrence River.

ONIATARÍ:IO (THE LAKE OF SHINING WATERS)

The Chippewa, Keepers of Tradition, dance and interact.

ERIELHONAN (LONG TAIL)

The Ottawa, Keepers of the Trade, dance and interact.

KAREGNONDI (LAKE)

The Potawatomi, Keepers of the Fire, dance and interact.

MICHIGAMI (GREAT WATER)

The Anishinaabe, Council of Three Fires, come together and dance and interact.

PW (GREAT SEA)

Lulu touches the Heirloom. Pain strikes her.

17TH-CENTURY FRENCH EXPLORERS, FUR TRADERS, and MISSIONARIES set foot on the shore. They terrorize and scare off the Anishinaabe. One colonizer resembles Petey. He pulls out a sword and prepares to strike down Lulu.

Present-day Shelby intervenes and stops him. The French runs off into the unknown.

End of "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Shelby helps Lulu up.

SHELBY

Ready to go to the parade? Woah, those are some neat-o rocks. Did you go swimming in Lake Michigan? You don't seem all that soaked.

LULU

I dried up super quick-

SHELBY

You scrapped your arm. Don't play with rocks, dear.

LULU

It more so messed with my head. The rocks played with me. For the parade, I've got perfect costume for this problem. A cast.

Lulu gathers the rocks. She holds the Petoskey with resentment.

SCENE 9

EXT. YPSILANTI CITY HALL - MORNING

Residents stand in line to speak
before Amanda and the Council.

RESIDENTS

Ypsilanti does not need a data center!

RESIDENT

My family in Saline can't sleep with all your
humming! Do we wanna lose sleep over a data
center?

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

Born and raised in Flint, and we do not want
you taking our clean water! No data centers!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

Can we rename Ypsilanti Yoopsilanti?

RESIDENTS

No!

RESIDENT

My cows are so stressed, they are birthing
stillborn calves. We've got no beef with you.

AMANDA

Nor do I.

RESIDENT

You heard me wrong. We've got no beef, thanks
to you. Your data center is gonna starve us.

AMANDA

Data centers would end world hunger!

RESIDENT

With your wealth, do you even know what hunger
feels like?

13. "THE STARVING ARTIST"

Amanda leaves and returns as an
avant-garde artist, with the Mr.
Rogers spirit.

AMANDA

I AM HUNGRY TO SEE HOW THIS WORLD WORKED.
HUNGRY TO EXPRESS MY HUMANITARIAN WORK!
I WAS FEEDING ART TO THE COMMUNITY,
FREEING THOSE WHO HAVE TRAPPED THEIR HUMANITY!
AND I AIN'T DONE THIS ALONE.

CONOR, Amanda's brother, appears as a silhouette or avatar or other subjective ways.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
WE WERE HUNGRY, MY BROTHER AND I, STARVED!
EATING TIME FOR ART BEFORE FEEDING OUR OWN BELLIES!
WE'VE HAD HOPES AND DREAMS TO BRING CLEAN WATER
PAINT WITH NO PAIN.

Amanda strikes paint.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I HOPE THAT MY DREAM PAINTS YOU A PICTURE.

Amanda and Conor graduate top of their class of 2006 in computer engineering at the University of Michigan. She goes to art school at Hope College while Conor starts the tech startup, Turkey Ventures.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
WE ONCE STARTED WITH NOTHING BUT FIRE IN OUR EYES.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS, BUT NO FEARS.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS, LET'S NOT FEAR.
HOPE, LOVE, PRAYERS, PLEASE DON'T FEAR.

Conor paves the way for AI art.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I WAS SKEPTICAL
ABOUT WHAT'S LOGICAL
ABOUT HIS AI.
MY BIG BROTHER WATCHED AS ARTISTS STARVED AND HE WANTED TO
CHANGE THAT.
HE NEEDED TO CHANGE ARTISTIC PATIENCE.
SO NO ONE EVER DIES FOR NOTHING.
HE SACRIFICED EVERYTHING.

Conor loses his lifework during the 2007 recession.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I NOW KNOW THAT THERE'S NOTHING TO SHOW FROM MY HEART.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEAR'S HERE TO...

FEAR NOT, I KNOW WHAT IT'S LIKE TO STARVE.
I WAS A STARVING ARTIST.

Cherry comes across Amanda. Cherry is about to greet her classmate, until she shows off her tech. With great disappointment, Cherry dismisses Amanda. Amanda soon gets expelled from art school.

AMANDA (CONT'D)

TECHNOLOGY AND I SHALL NOT
LET ANYONE END UP A STARVING ARTIST.
TRUST ME, YOU WON'T END UP LIKE MY BROTHER.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS 'TIL HE DIED.

I'VE HELD BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS 'TIL HIS SUICIDE.

Amanda sees Cherry grieve, after
her own brother Petey's suicide.
This time, Amanda dismisses Cherry
and takes over Turkey Ventures in
honor of Conor, becoming the
businessperson she is now.

AMANDA (CONT'D)

MY CREATIVE SPIRIT BLED, SWEAT, TORE WHEN HE DIED...
I LOVE HIM AS THE STARVING ARTIST.

The Residents become content. The
Council approves the data center.

Amanda gets out a map of Michigan.
Many cities and towns are checked
off. She checks off Ypsilanti. She
points to Elk Rapids.

End of "[THE STARVING ARTIST](#)"

SCENE 10

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - NOON

The Grande Parade is underway. As
Jacob is this year's Grand
Marshall, the VanDam's theme is
Musical Theatre. The VanDams
adjust their costumes and makeup.

Lulu wears an Evan Hansen cast.

Petoskey adjusts his suspenders.

LULU

Who are you supposed to be, Petoskey?

PETOSKEY

Um... Jud- Uh?

LULU

Oh! Jud Fry. That guy suuuuccckkkkssss. He
thinks it is O K to beat up women.

PETOSKEY

Are you supposed to be Tiny um Tim um Timmy?

Lulu waves at a window.

LULU

Waving through a window?

PETOSKEY

So, my guy sucks. And your guy's creepy.

The Twins dress up as Elphaba and Glinda.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

And those two are like- princess witches?

The Twins monkey around.

LULU

Nah, they're flying monkeys! *They're Elphaba and Glinda.* This is Musical Theatre 101.

PETOSKEY

I hate musicals.

Lulu approaches Jacob, who is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*.

LULU

Wednesday, Jud Fry is against everything you stand for.

JACOB

At least I get to stand at the end, unlike Jud Fry. By the way, isn't this inspiring you?

A bell rings in the distance.

Jacob heads to his post.

PETOSKEY

How's that musical you're writing?

Lulu pulls out a giant scrapbook with deer stickers.

LULU

Dearborn the musical! It'll have its showcase at my middle school fall talent show! Emma's gonna play Mama Deer, Lukas is Papa Deer, Camille is Cathy Dee- Oh! And Dionne's uh Lake Superior, Lee's gonna be Huron-

Petoskey grows bored and walks away.

LULU (CONT'D)

Where ya goin'?! Eh, I'll have you singing like
a canary in front of the family in due time.

Cherry whistles and gather the
family together.

CHERRY

This is the parade you all've been waiting for.
You'd expect I can give a pep talk, being
married to a sport guy, but he's a hockey guy.
They don't talk, they beat up. Anyone got some
positive news they'd like to share before we
proceed?

SHELBY

We've got a new winner for this year's rock
collection.

Shelby steps aside to show Lulu in
all her glory. She drops most of
the rocks on the ground.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Wooooaaahhhh... Lulu beat Petoskey! Lulu beat
Petoskey! Lulu beat Petoskey!

LIZZIE

You didn't happen to buy these at a rock store?

14. "FRAUDWAY"

Lulu reveals the Heirloom.

PETOSKEY

WHERE? WHERE DID YOU GET THAT?

LULU

OH DEER.

PETOSKEY

NO ANSWERS, HUH?

LULU

A DEER.

PETOSKEY

SERIOUS?

LULU

SERIOUSLY A DEER.

Lulu refuses to give it back.

PETOSKEY

JUST GIVE IT BACK.
HAVE IT YOUR WAY.
YOU FRAUD...

LULU

LET ME ENJOY THE SPOILS.
THIS JEALOUSY REALLY MAKES MY MOM'S BLOOD BOIL.
"CONGRATULATIONS" IS ALL YOU NEED TO SAY.
FORGET ROCKS FOR A SECOND AND LET US ENJOY THIS PARADE.

VANDAMS W/O PETOSKEY

IT'S BROADWAY!

As Perry drives the Ford Model T,
Willy sits in the passenger side,
and Cherry is in the back seat in
the most elaborate costume ever.

VANDAMS W/O PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

GRANDE PARADE ON HARBOR DAYS!

The VanDams hand out candy and
theatre memorabilia to the parade
crowd and real-life Audience.

JACOB

Welcome to the Harbor Days Grande Parade!
Thanks for inviting me as your Grand Marshall.
Before this, I was on the Addams Family
national tour. That's why I'm feeling so
Wednesday on a Saturday. But yes, the Grande
Parade runs annually from noon to 1PM along
River Street, downtown Elk Rapids. Awards will
be given out to various categories including
Best Float, Best Motorized, Best Non-Motorized,
Best Commercial Business, Best Instrumental,
and the Most Creative. *We all know who the
winning family's gonna be...*

VANDAMS

BROADWAY! BROADWAY! BROADWAY! BROADWAY!
NOTHING SHALL STAND BETWEEN US AND FAME!

Jacob hands the Most Creative
Award plaque to Willy.

LULU

YOU COULD LIVE FOREVER IF YOU GAVE UP BEING A ROCK IN A HARD
PLACE.

VANDAMS W/O PETOSKEY

A ROCK IN A HARD PLACE.

PETOSKEY

LIKE MY FATHER...

Lulu considers giving back the Heirloom for Petoskey's sake.

In Lulu's perspective, as she is about to hand over the Heirloom to Petoskey, Colonizer Petey steps into her line of sight. She smashes the Heirloom on the ground, splitting the hearty Petoskey stone in half.

In Petoskey's perspective, he sees his father Petey once more. When Lulu smashes the Heirloom, Petey vanishes. Petoskey is shattered like the Petoskey before him. He is heartbroken like never before.

The parade reaches BANH MICHIGAN restaurant. Jasper is handing out food to the crowd and Audience with the Vinh Chin family.

Lulu waves at Jasper.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

You're not taking my godfather, too...
SEE YOU ON...

VANDAMS

FRAUDWAY!

Petoskey slaps Lulu. It is a bad look for Jud Fry to beat up the broken-armed Evan Hansen.

VANDAMS W/O LIZ, PETOSKEY, SHELBY

THIS IS FRAUDWAY!
BREAK HEARTS TODAY!
SING YOUR HEART OUT ON FRAUDWAY,
WHERE SONGS GOT NO SAY!

Liz and Shelby try to break up the fight. Suddenly, a memory washes over them.

2008 Petey comes out of nowhere and hurts Shelby. Liz redirects her attention to them.

PETEY

They stole our jobs and my little sister, too!

LIZZIE

Petosk- Petey, stop! Get your hands off her!

PETHEY & PETOSKEY

She... She...

LIZZIE

Her husband is a loving hardworking man. Even if he's a transplant. If you cannot love her addition into your family, I no longer want to be an addition to this family.

Liz throws away her wedding ring.

PETHEY & PETOSKEY

Not you, too...

Petey tries to hug or kiss Liz.
She dismisses and tends to Shelby.
Petey exits and starts up the car.

In reality, Jasper pulls Petoskey away from Lulu.

Jacob runs into the orchestra pit and blows a wind instrument.

JACOB

This ain't Broadway. It's Fraudway. The parade is over! We do not condone these acts of violence. Huh... On behalf of the Harbor Days committee, I hereby revoke my family's Most Creative Award.

A Resident removes the award plaque from Willy's grasp.

VANDAMS W/O LIZ & PETOSKEY

LOST?
WE CAN'T LOSE.
YOU'VE HURT...

CHERRY

OUR CHANCES!

PERRY

FAMILY.

LULU
PETOSKEY, GO DROWN.

VANDAMS W/O LIZ & PETOSKEY
THIS FAMILY WILL NEVER LET
THIS DROWN!

LULU (CONT'D)
PLEASE DROWN!

Jasper helps Lulu get up. He dismisses Petoskey.

End of "FRAUDWAY"

15. "KICK ROCKS"

Petoskey faces Liz.

PETOSKEY

PLEASE SEE, MOM. IT'S NOT WHAT IT LOOK LIKE.
BELIEVE ME, MOM. I AIN'T MEAN TO HURT HER.
DON'T LEAVE ME, MOM! SHE STARTED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE

SON...
GO KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT!
AS MY CHILD, YOU KNOW BETTER...

PETOSKEY

VIOLENCE WON'T END?

Lizzie levels herself with
Petoskey before distancing away.

LIZZIE

SON...
WHAT MATTERS: VIOLENCE IS NOT THE ANSWER!

PETOSKEY

A RAGING MONSTER'S WHAT I LOOK LIKE.
BEEN A MONSTER, WHO IS MEANT TO HURT ALL.
DO LEAVE THIS MONSTER, WHO'S STONED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE

SON...
GO
KICK ROCKS!

The VanDams join in with Liz.

VANDAMS W/O LULU

KICK ROCKS!

LIZZIE

IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT.

PETOSKEY

I DIDN'T START IT!

VANDAMS W/O LULU

WHO STARTED IT?

LIZZIE

MAYBE AS MY HUSBAND'S CHILD, YOU DON'T KNOW BETTER...

VANDAMS W/O LULU

THE VIOLENCE WON'T END!

Lulu is about to lodge a punch at
Petoskey. Instead, she throws the
Heirloom at him.

The Keepers of Faith, Fire, Trade
appear before Petoskey.

KEEPERS

MICHILIMACKINAC...
THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE.

As the Keepers vanish, Petoskey
ponders about the Mackinac Bridge.

PETOSKEY

ALL THAT MATTER'S THAT WE BRIDGE THE LOVE...
IT'S ALWAYS THE ANSWER!

Petoskey faces a body of water.

LIZZIE

SON,
KICK ROCKS!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

KICK ROCKS!
WHY PETOSKEY?

VANDAMS W/O LULU

KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!

VANDAMS W/O LULU (CONT'D)

KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!

Liz reaches for Petoskey.

LIZZIE

NO!

VANDAMS W/O LULU

KICK...

LULU

REMEMBER TO FLOAT!

LIZZIE

PETOSKEY!

VANDAMS W/O LULU

...ROCKS!

Like his father, Petoskey sinks
into the body of water.

End of "KICK ROCKS"

END OF ACT I

INTERMISSION

ACT II

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2016 - DAY (6 YEARS AGO)

16. "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

The Harbor Days talent show has a handy line-up, including 7-year-old Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU
WELCOME TO MICHIGAN.
ARE YOU FEELING LOST?
ALWAYS REMEMBER, FRIEND:
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
OR FACE YOUR LEFT HAND DOWN!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

Petoskey puts his left hand, palm facing, over Lulu's right hand to form Michigan's Peninsulas. They point to the respective cities.

LULU & PETOSKEY
LET'S START WITH THE THUMB.
DETROIT, DEARBORN, WARREN, PORT HURON, FLINT, HAMTRAMCK-

LULU
"Ham-trammkk?" It's pronounced: "ham-tra-mik."

PETOSKEY
Ope. Is anyone even gonna use this song?

LULU
No, but you don't want no angry Midwesterners.
So pronounce them right, Yooper boy.

PETOSKEY
Aight, troll gal...

LULU & PETOSKEY
HAMTRAMCK, ROYAL OAK, AND DON'T FORGET ANN ARBOR.
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

LET'S POINT TO THE PALM.

LANSING, MT. PLEASANT, SAGINAW, KALAMAZOO, CLAIRE, SAINT
LOUIS, GRAND RAPIDS, AND LET'S FORGET WYOMING...
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey wear Wyoming
High School gears (David Quang
Pham's alma mater).

PETOSKEY

WHAT BRINGS YOU TO MICHIGAN?
WE DO HAVE THE BEST SOCKS!

LULU

DON'T FORGET THE MITTENS!

PETOSKEY

PUT YOUR LEFT PALM DOWN.

LULU

OR FACE YOUR *RIGHT* PALM UP!

PETOSKEY

PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

LULU

AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY

NOW AROUND THE HAND...
ST. JOSEPH, SAUGATUCK, HOLLAND, GRAND HAVEN, MUSKEGON,
TRAVERSE CITY, ALPENA...

Petoskey points to himself.

LULU

WHO COULD FORGET PETOSKEY...?

LULU & PETOSKEY

HANDS COME IN HANDY!

NOW THE OTHER HAND!

MARQUETTE, ESCANABA, HOUGHTON, SAULT STE. MARIE, MACKINAC,
IRON MOUNTAIN, KEWEENAW.

LULU

DID WE FORGET ANYTHING?

Petoskey brings out a Snoopy doll
from *Peanuts*! He and Lulu pretend
to ride rollercoasters and
waterslides. They soon hold up a
sign that reads: "President Mark
Camille Jourden of Michigan's
Adventures: Please stage us!"

PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S ADVENTURES!

LULU
TWO PARKS!

PETOSKEY
FOR THE PRICE OF ONE!

LULU & PETOSKEY
FUN! FUN!

LULU PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S LOWER PENINSULA! MICHIGAN'S UPPER PENINSULA!

LULU & PETOSKEY
FOR A THOUSAND TOWNSHIPS, TOWNSHIPS!

Lulu and Petoskey go into the
Audience and applaud them.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
HIGH-FIVE EACH OTHER!
APPLAUD YOURSELVES!

LOVE MICHIGAN!
DON'T EVER FEEL LOST!
REMEMBER TO USE YOUR HANDS!
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey do a Pat-a-cake,
pat-a-cake, baker's man game.

End of "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

SCENE 2

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

Liz watches the 2016 recording of
her kids' song on her phone.

LIZZIE
I guess Petoskey could be anywhere!

Cherry and Perry check in.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

My son?

CHERRY

No luck.

PERRY

You should've named him Limestone. He would've been easier to find.

LIZZIE

Science is not helping.

CHERRY

When did it ever?

17. "PETOSKEY"

Liz goes ask around the Audience.

LIZZIE

HAVE YOU, HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?

Liz spots Amanda in the distance.
She confronts her, but Amanda has
a heart made of stone.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

MY ROCK, MY ROCK WITH A SOFT SPOT?

MY STONE, MY STONE FULL OF HEART?

You'd expect AI be able to find missing
children!

AMANDA

I didn't promise it'd find little kids but spy
on them. No problemo.

LIZZIE

It only makes lost kids more lost...

As Liz searches, Petoskey gets off
a bus with a map app on his phone,
carrying a fishing pole. As she
asks the residents glued to their
phones, he approaches the Mackinac
Bridge. Petoskey disappears there.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?

HAVE YOU, HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?

MY ROCK, MY ROCK WITH A SOFT SPOT?

MY STONE, MY STONE FULL OF HEART?

MY HEART, MY HEART CANNOT TAKE-

Liz collapses.

Amanda sees Liz's struggle and comes to her aid. She drops a device by Liz, then leaves.

The VanDams, without Lulu, come to her aid.

VANDAMS

LIZ... YOU ARE NOT ALONE. WE WILL FIND YOUR COOL ROCK.

The VanDams give away Petoskey stones to the Audience. They hand one to Liz.

VANDAMS (CONT'D)

PATTERNS.

PATTERNS.

PETOSKEY HAS A PATTERN.

PATTERNS!

LET US FIND YOUR,

LET US FIND YOUR ROCK!

The Twins steal Liz's stone.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

COOL ROCK!

Liz chases after the Twins, then returns with the Petoskey stone.

LIZZIE

PETOSKEY!

VANDAMS

LET US FIND PETOSKEY!

End of "PETOSKEY"

Everyone exits as search parties. Liz figures out to use Amanda's device, and walks off when the tracker turns on.

SCENE 3

INT. BANH MICHIGAN - DAY

Lulu enters the restaurant and sits by Jasper on the phone.

JASPER

I'll give you the BANH MICHIGAN secret formula if you find him. Of course *alive*, you sicko.

Jasper hangs up.

JASPER (CONT'D)

You found Petoskey?

Lulu faces down on the table,
crying.

JASPER (CONT'D)

Don't lose yourself, Lulu...

LULU

I lost my cousin. I lost my family. All hope is
lost.

JASPER

Your family is mine and you have only gained
more of my respect. And everyone's a peninsula
away, whereas my family's continents.

LULU

Don't we have planes now?

JASPER

There's planes my entire life. That's besides
the point. I lost *touch*.

LULU

How do you get a sense of how your family's
doing?

JASPER

Not a sense of touch but tastes and smells. You
know what my family always said?

18. "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

LULU

YOUR FAMILY SAID WHAT?

JASPER

NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU COME FROM
AS LONG AS YOU BREAK BREAD.

LULU

YOU AND YA BANH MI NEEDA GIVE IT A REST.

JASPER

SOMEONE'S COMPASS AIN'T PASSING MY TEST.

Jacob enters the restaurant.

JACOB

SHALOM.

LULU

BONJOUR!

JASPER
CHAU, JACOB!

JACOB
LOOKING FOR OUR MISSING COUSIN WORKED ME UP AN APPETITE.

JASPER
I'M SURE KOSHER WILL GIVE US CLOSURE.

JACOB
MAKE MY BREAD A BRIDGE ROLL.

JASPER
NOT FEELING FRENCH TODAY?

LULU
THE BRITISH INVASION WAS SO YESTERDAY.

Jasper makes a Banh Mi for Jacob.

JASPER
NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
I DON'T CARE IF YOU'RE STRAIGHT OR CURVED
SO LONG AS YOU TRY THEM BAGUETTES.

JACOB
Just cause I do musical theatre does not make
me gay. Look at Lulu, wanting to be a musical
writer, does that make her-

LULU
Yup, I'm gay.

JASPER
Open-and-shut case.

JACOB
Okay...

LULU
Banh mi turned me gay.

JASPER
Case back open...

JACOB
Haha! Welp...
TODA FOR THE BRIDGE!

LULU
THE BRIDGE?

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC.

LULU & JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU GO
SO LONG AS YOU LISTEN TO THE BREAD.

End of "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

Liz enters the restaurant.

LULU & JASPER (CONT'D)
We know where Petoskey is.

LIZZIE
I have a feeling, it's...

JASPER
The bridge...

LIZZIE
I...

JASPER
I'll go to Mackinac for you.

LULU
And I need to go apologize...

Liz punches her hand into her
other hand. Lulu acknowledges it.

LULU (CONT'D)
Apologize with some deserved violence.

Jasper kisses a Banh Mi.

JASPER
Banh mi, you never fail me!

Lulu and Jasper run out.

LIZZIE
Thanks for the Turk cameras, Amanda...

Liz sets up a boat.

SCENE 4

EXT. MACKINAC ISLAND - MARCH 2006 - DAY (16 YEARS AGO)

Liz and Petey sail on their boat
that they made at their shipyard.

LIZZIE

The tide is turning on the public sentiment
towards the war, but at least the shipbuilding
business is booming.

PETHEY

We'll win every battle, thanks to our shipyard.

LIZZIE

Are we even gonna conquer Mackinac Strait? The
water is rough here.

PETHEY

And it's still winter.

LIZZIE

Thanks for being up for this.

PETHEY

No, it's you.

LIZZIE & PETHEY

Nah, we asked at the same time. Jinx!

PETHEY

You hear that?

LIZZIE

Ah! The boat's leaking.

Liz patches up a hole in the boat.

PETHEY

You're a natural at this.

LIZZIE

And you are... Uh...

PETHEY

(Blushing)

Yes...?

19. "NATURAL BEAUTY"

Liz taps Petey's nose.

LIZZIE

YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL.

PETEEY
YOU THINK I'M BEAUTIFUL?

LIZZIE
JUST TAKE THE COMPLIMENT.
YOU DON'T HAVE TO GET ALL WEIRD ABOUT IT.

PETEEY
WHATEVER YOU SAY, MS. NATURAL.

Petey motions to Liz that he has
questions. They may nod "yes."

PETEEY (CONT'D)
AM I BEAUTIFUL AS THE GREAT LAKES?

LIZZIE
AM I NATURAL AS THE GLACIERS WHO CARVED IT?

PETEEY
AM I BEAUTIFUL LIKE HER SNOW?

LIZZIE
AM I NATURAL LIKE HER HILLS AND COVES?

PETEEY
WAS I BEAUTY SHOVELING IN A BLIZZARD?

Petey shovels.

LIZZIE
WAS I A NATURAL CATCHING HAIL LIKE A WIZARD?

Liz catches hail like a baseball.

PETEEY
HAIL YEAH!

LIZZIE
YOU ARE A BEAUTY
IN NATURE.

PETEEY (CONT'D)
YOU ARE A NATURAL
AND YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL.

Liz looks at the time and taps her
feet impatiently. Petey points to
the landscapes.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
BREATH TAKING VALLEYS!
PRETTY FAST RIVERS!
ENORMOUS MOUNTAINS!
MASSIVE PERCHED SAND DUNES!

PETEEY (CONT'D)
SWOOPING LIKE A HAWK!
FLOATING LIKE AN OTTER!
CLIMBING LIKE A WOLF!
RUNNING LIKE A DEER!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
DUMPSTER TRUCKS PILE UP ON I-75!

PETHEY
LIVE LIKE A RACCOON!

LIZZIE
HAIL NO!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)	PETHEY
YOU ARE SO SLOW.	YOU ARE A-
ARE YOU GONNA ASK ME	BEAUTY?
SOMETHING?	THIS IS UNNATURAL.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
AM I BEAUTIFUL OR NOT?

PETHEY
YOU ARE NATURAL AS THE UH...?

LIZZIE
NEVER BEAUTIFUL AT ALL?

PETHEY
YOU ARE NATURAL AS THE RINGS OF SATURN.

LIZZIE
AM I A BEAUTY WEARING NO RING?

PETHEY
YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL AS IMPATIENT.

LIZZIE
YOU'RE STILL SLOW.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)	PETHEY
JUST ACT NATURAL.	JUST ACT SURPRISED.

As the boat approaches Mackinac Island, Liz's family and Petey's family run out with proposal posters. One reads: "Will you marry me, Petey?" The other reads: "Will you marry me, Lizzie?"

Liz and Petey get on their knees simultaneously and pull out their rings. Flustered, they laugh. They set up the wedding ceremony on Mackinac Island.

In their wedding attires, Liz and Petey walk down the aisle and center themselves. They kiss.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)	PETHEY (CONT'D)
WE ARE A NATURAL	WE ARE A BEAUTY
AND WE ARE BEAUTIFUL.	IN NATURE.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
WE ARE NOW MARRIED!

LIZZIE & PETEY
YOU ARE A NATURAL BEAUTY.

As Liz kisses Petey's cheek, he
stares bittersweetly at the
Mackinac Bridge in the distance.

SCENE 5

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

20. "ROCK BOTTOM"

On the creaky bridge, with a
fishing rod in hand, Petoskey
looks down the Mackinac Strait.

PETOSKEY
EVERY BRIDGE HIDES WATER.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
UNDER.

PETOSKEY
EVERY STONE SHOWS PAIN.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
SHAPED BY RAIN.
EVERYDAY THIS BEDROCK SLEEPWALKS.

PETOSKEY
SO SICK AND TIRED OF STICKING LOVED ONES IN HARD PLACES.
I DON'T WANNA EVER SHOW MY FACE.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
CAST YOUR FATE.

PETOSKEY
HIDE AWAY MY SHAME.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
YOUR HATE.

Lulu runs in.

Petoskey notices Jasper in the
Ford Model T in the distance. They
wave. He is then on his guard.

Lulu is about to sock Petoskey in
the face. Deservedly so. Instead,
she hands him the Heirloom.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
(Gospel)

PETOSKEY...

PETOSKEY...

THE JEWEL OF MICHIGAN...

Lulu looks around to see who is
singing and fogging up the bridge.

Petoskey hooks the Heirloom on the
fishing pole and cast the line
down the Strait, surprising Lulu.

End of "ROCK BOTTOM"

21. "FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS"

The bridge fogs up, separating
Petoskey and Lulu from Jasper.

Petoskey's fishing pole is tugged
then pulled out of sight.

MICHILIMACKINAC, the Great Turtle,
towers the Kids. The Turtle sounds
like Petey...

KEEPERS (V.O.)

MICHILIMACKINAC... THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE...

PETOSKEY

THE GREAT TURTLE...

LULU

(Whispering to Petoskey)

Turtles are slow. If we make a run for it-

The Turtle blocks their path.

MICHILIMACKINAC

I'm not like my slow cousin, the Tortoise. Are
you hear to join me and bridge these two lands?

LULU

We're on top of a bridge.

MICHILIMACKINAC

I mean spiritually. Ever since the glaciers
melted, I've held these two peninsulas
together. When humans built bridges of their
own, I was no longer bound to the physical
world.

PETOSKEY

Is that what my dad's doing? Bridging the
spirit world?

MICHILIMACKINAC

You must be Petoskey. I've heard so much about you, yet he hasn't met you. But he heard my call, and we met as bodies of water.

PETOSKEY

Why did you take my dad away?

MICHILIMACKINAC

WHEN YOUR LOVED ONE PASSES...

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)

LULU & PETOSKEY

NO LONGER LEAVING FOOTPRINTS NO LONGER...
ON THE WORLD.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

THE WORLD NO LONGER SPINS.

MICHILIMACKINAC

YOUR FAMILY DON'T LAY FOREVER IN TOMBS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)

LULU & PETOSKEY

THE DEAD'S SET IN STONE AND THE DEAD LIVE ON?
FOSSILIZED.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)

SO EVERYONE'S FAMILIES REMEMBERED IN THE FOSSILS.

LULU & PETOSKEY

FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS?

MICHILIMACKINAC

THEM FOSSILS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)

I'm here to take everyone suffering from pain.

PETOSKEY

Can you take mom's pain away?

MICHILIMACKINAC

If she wants to take a shortcut here, like her lover. Be my guest. Anyone can be my guest.

LULU & PETOSKEY

No no no.

LULU

We don't need another soul to be your guest.

MICHILIMACKINAC

One thinks shortcuts save time, but it makes all lose their ways anyways.

LULU

It's like AI...

MICHILIMACKINAC

Glad you have the audacious intelligence to put A and I together... Looks like the peninsulas have gifted me two sacrifices: a farm boy from the north and a city gal from the south.

PETOSKEY

No no no. Take me only. After all, my father's here. And plus, Lulu smells like car oil.

LULU

I'm gonna light you up, Petoskey!

The Turtle smells Banh Mi.

MICHILIMACKINAC

That delicious smell of a Banh Mi.

PETOSKEY

You know Banh Mi?

MICHILIMACKINAC

It must be Jasper. Petey speaks highly of him. Is Jasper open to being sacrificed?

LULU & PETOSKEY

No!

LULU

Take me instead!

MICHILIMACKINAC

So jealous my sister's living it up in Vietnam. I could've settled in the Caribbeans, by Sierra Leone, Greece, Brazil, Israel, Ecuador. But no... I chose Michigan. The food ain't bad, the weather could be better.

By the way, I'm kidding. No sacrifices here, so long as you stop these data centers. They are rather noisy. It drives me insane.

PETOSKEY

For all humans...

LULU

...it drives us insane, too.

MICHILIMACKINAC

Keep the Great Lakes *great*, my children.
WHEN YOUR LOVED ONE PASSES...

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D) LULU & PETOSKEY
NO LONGER LEAVING FOOTPRINTS NO LONGER...
ON THE WORLD.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
THE WORLD NO LONGER SPINS.

MICHILIMACKINAC
YOUR FAMILY DON'T LAY FOREVER IN TOMBS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D) LULU & PETOSKEY
THE DEAD'S SET IN STONE AND THE DEAD LIVE ON?
FOSSILIZED.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
SO EVERYONE'S FAMILIES REMEMBERED IN THE FOSSILS.

LULU & PETOSKEY
FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS.

KEEPERS (V.O.)
MICHILIMACKINAC... THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE...

The Turtle sinks back into the
Mackinac Strait.

End of "FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS"

The fog clears up. Petoskey hugs
Lulu.

LULU
I'd punch you off this bridge...

PETOSKEY
Thanks for having mercy on me...

Lulu and Petoskey walk away from
the Mackinac Bridge.

A punch is audible.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Ouch! Ope...

LULU
Told ya I'd punch ya off the bridge!

JASPER
Hold your vengeance for Amanda Wayland and her
cronies!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JASPER
Let's save Elk Rapids and the world!

They drive off.

END OF ACT II

ACT IIISCENE 1**EXT. ELK RAPIDS - EVENING**

In front of a crowd, Amanda and her OLIGARCHS exhibit models of their data centers.

AMANDA

We will save money! Lotsa money!

RESIDENT

Where'd you come up with such predictions?

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

Who made your models?

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

How'd ya decide ya fit today?

AMANDA & OLIGARCHS

Ope... AI does the work for us.

Jasper drives in the Ford Model T
with Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU & PETOSKEY

AI does not work!

AMANDA

Neither do kids... Not yet, until we bring back-

OLIGARCHS

Child laborrrrrrrrrrrrr! Muahahahahahahahaha!!!

OLIGARCH

Ya need to work on ya evil laugh. Let AI help!

JASPER

We don't need AI determining good and evil
anymore. We need our Lake House back.

AMANDA

You lost the Petoskey. Nothing matches a trade
like a cool rock.

JASPER

How about my BANH MI restaurant?

LULU & PETOSKEY

Jasper?!

AMANDA

The Southeast gem of the Midwest? Besides water, our data center needs her cafeteria.

JASPER

I'll also throw in my golf course.

AMANDA

Such small businessowner owning lotsa properties. It makes a monopoly blush in envy.

A FIGURE comes out of nowhere.

JASPER

My love... You've returned.

The Figure hugs Jasper and suddenly a tablet appears in his hands. Lulu and Petoskey shake Jasper out of a trance.

LULU & PETOSKEY

That's not your love!

LULU

It's gullible, falling for these digital scams.

PETOSKEY

They're unreal. They've been dead a long time.

JASPER

I've just signed away BANH MIchigan.

RESIDENTS

With nothing to show for-

Most Resident's phones including Jasper's ding. Deceased Figures, including Jasper's, tend to the grieving.

JASPER

It's not the first my family has lost the restaurant...

AMANDA

Anyone else oblige to give up their homes?

Cherry shows up.

CHERRY

All of us needs our houses. You stole these people's homes and you better give them back.

AMANDA

These people have fairly traded in their deeds
for another chance at seeing their loved ones
who passed on? Who could put a price on that?

CHERRY

You did! A house for an artificial soul!

Petey comes out of nowhere.

AMANDA

Would you say he's artificial?

CHERRY

Petey?

PETEY

I should've chosen my life over the house. But
you've got a second chance to pick my life over
my house.

Petey pulls out a tablet with a
contract. Cherry takes it and
prepares to sign it.

The rest of the VanDams show up.

VANDAMS W/O LULU, PETOSKEY, LIZ

The Lake House is not what we call "home." The
people who live in it are our home.

AMANDA

Welp, settles it. I can call Elk Rapids home.

RESIDENTS

You sure?

AMANDA

Lemme ask AI. Hey, would you call this town my
home?

AI

Good evening, Amanda Wayland, you gorgeous tech
giant. Of course, I would call this town your
home. And everyone's home-

AMANDA

She's hallucinating, again.

LULU

You rely on AI cause ya got no N-I.

OLIGARCHS

N-I?

CHERRY

Natural Intelligence.

OLIGARCHS

Wut???

AMANDA

Don't ever say the N word ever again.

VANDAMS

Natural beauty!

Amanda and the Oligarchs convulse.

AMANDA & OLIGARCHS

Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope uugghh!

AMANDA

Scapegoat dot AI, now!

Everyone's phones ping.

RESIDENT

Headline: the VanDams stole from the kids' charity?!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

The VanDams have been dumping Model T oil into Elk Lake?!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

The VanDams burn down an orphanage?!

AMANDA

Scapegoat dot AI now with hyper realistic photos included.

VANDAMS

The people of Elk Rapids are on our side-

The Residents surround the VanDams like predatory creatures.

AMANDA

And society- The world is on capitalism's side. It sets a late stage for my amazing creatures.

CHERRY

Looks like Ms. Photoshopper's gonna kill us all-

LULU & PETOSKEY

Aunt Cherry?

PERRY & SHELBY

Before we die...

JACOB

Wanna wear our ridiculous costumes...

VANDAMS W/O CHERRY, LIZ

For ol' time sake?

CHERRY

Back trunk of the Ford Model T is all our costumes for the last four decades...

As the Residents surround the VanDams, ready to attack, the VanDams put on old costumes from past Harbor Days. The Residents admire them.

RESIDENT

We can't hurt the VanDams.

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

They are the spirit of this town.

AMANDA

Look at them. Using their own humanity to bring messy creativity to the world. What a shame.

RESIDENT

What a shame? It's *who* and that's you.

AMANDA

Me? The shame would be on me if I leave the city of stones unturned.

RESIDENT

We don't need another city turned into a data center.

RESIDENTS

Yeah!

AMANDA

Data Rapids has a nice ring to it.

RESIDENT

The VanDam is our ring...

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

And we're committed to them.

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

VanDams! VanDams! VanDams!

AMANDA

Activate Elk dot AI!

22. "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"

Everyone's phones ping. They get distracted.

RESIDENT

Check out this cute elk doing karate!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

My elk is doing a comedy routine!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

And this is Aretha Franklin as an elk!

Amanda and the Oligarchs make their way through the distracted crowd to the Ford Model T.

Lulu and Petoskey block Amanda.

PETOSKEY

We don't have our phones.

LULU

Our parents grounded us.

Holding a frying pan, Milly sneaks behind Amanda and the Oligarchs. She knocks them out.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Grammy Milly!

Lulu and Petoskey go to hug Milly. She stops them.

MILLY

Ope ope ope... You need baths. But first, want me wipe a batch of your favorite cookies?! I don't want your dirty butts in the backseat, so get in the trunk.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Anything for you, Grammy!

Lulu and Petoskey get in the trunk. Milly closes it then vanishes.

Amanda and the Oligarchs get up.

AMANDA

Works every time...

The residents face Amanda.

VANDAMS

Those wealth hoarders are kidnapping our kids!

RESIDENTS

Get 'em!

The Ford Model T drives away from
the pursuing crowd.

OLIGARCH

Is it morally right to lock kids in the trunk?

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)

Who cares?! We can sell them for parts!

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)

I love being rich!

AMANDA

Elk Rapids, check. Next, Grand Rapids!

AI

Redirecting!

Fireworks soar and explode around.

Liz gets off a bus nearby. She
pulls out her phone tracker. She
sees the Ford Model T drive by as
she expected. She runs after them.

AMANDA

No way... Is that?

LULU & PETOSKEY

Mackinac Bridge!

OLIGARCHS

We have to cross!

AMANDA

The bridge crossed my heart and made me hope to
die. I can't. I won't. I refuse!

OLIGARCHS

We have no choice. They're gaining on us!

AMANDA

The living behind us or the dead ahead?!

The GHOST OF HENRY FORD manifests
inside the Ford Model T, chained
up like a Charles Dickens ghost.

AMANDA (CONT'D)

The ghost of Henry Ford???!

OLIGARCHS

Our lord and savior...

AMANDA

What happened to you?

FORD

This is what anti-Semitism and being anti-union does to you. Distribute your wealth or else!

OLIGARCH

Well, at least there's cryptocurrency.

FORD

We have the internet in Hell, too. You think angels invented WIFI?!

AMANDA

Get off my plane of existence!

SCENE 2

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - DAY

Amanda crashes the Ford Model T off the side of the bridge. She and the Oligarchs climb out. The Ford falls further down, making it hard to reach. The Ghost chases away the Oligarchs.

Liz reaches the wreckage.

AMANDA

You changed my GPS destination, didn't you?

LIZZIE

Not U. A I.

AMANDA

Your rock and pearl are still in the trunk!

LIZZIE

Face the water.

AMANDA

You face the water!

LIZZIE

Hold onto my legs while I reach down.

Amanda pulls Liz down to get to the Ford trunk. She almost lets go of Liz. Shelby runs in and grabs Liz, assisting Amanda.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Shelby?!

SHELBY

Shall we?

Liz opens the trunk, revealing a dizzy Lulu and Petoskey. She pulls them up.

The rest of the VanDams and Residents reach the wreckage.

The Ford Model T abruptly falls to the Mackinac Strait below.

WILLY

Farewell, Ford Model T...

AMANDA

I'm sorry.

WILLY

Mackinac Bridge has taken many things from me.
I'm glad it didn't take any more of you.

Collapsing on her knees, Amanda cries uncontrollably.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

You can cry in Hell!

AMANDA

This was where my brother left home. Bridges are supposed to unite lands...

LIZZIE & AMANDA

...not divide souls.

The Aunties help Amanda up.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Let's not divide our souls, no more.

Shelby holds Lulu's hand.

Liz holds Petoskey's hand.

LIZZIE

Son... We're taking the shortcut.

End of "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"

23. "WATER TO MY SOUL"

On the foggy bridge is the broken
Heirloom.

The VanDams and Amanda walk on the
bridge, leaving the Residents
behind.

WHEN? LIZZIE

WHEN? CHERRY

WHEN? PERRY

WHEN? SHELBY

WHEN WILL I EVER LET GO?
LIZZIE, AUNTIES, AMANDA

Michilimackinac and the Mackinac
Ghosts appear in the mist.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHEN YOU OPEN YOUR EYES AND SEE THE PAIN SHOW...

WHERE? AMANDA

WHERE? CHERRY MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHERE?

WHERE? PERRY

WHERE? SHELBY MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHERE?

WHERE DO ALL MY TEARS FLOW? LIZZIE, AUNTIES, AMANDA
FLOW? MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)

The Ghosts step aside to reveal
Petey in all his glory.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
WELL YOU JUST HAVE TO ASK THIS POOR SOUL...

MY POOR SOUL... LIZZIE PETEY
NOW A HAPPY SOUL...

YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...
LIZZIE & PETEY

LIZZIE
WHERE YOU GO.

PETEEY
I'LL FLOW!

AUNTIES & MACKINAC GHOSTS
NO MATTER WHERE I GO I WILL FLOW...

LIZZIE
UPSTREAM.

PETEEY
DOWNSTREAM.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

Liz and Petey kiss.

LIZZIE & PETEEY
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...
MY SOUL...
YOU ARE MY SOUL!

Petey hugs Cherry and Perry. He and Shelby lock eyes. She lovingly slaps him before hugging him. They all share a final dance before he hands his broken Heirloom to Liz.

Liz joins Petoskey and Shelby joins Lulu.

Liz, Petoskey, Shelby, and Lulu wave as Petey vanishes with the other ghosts once more into the foggy bridge.

Liz puts the Heirloom on Petoskey.

Amanda tosses her phone off the bridge. Conor's silhouette appears in the mist. Amanda runs to him, disappearing in the fog.

The VanDams continue on. They finally cross the bridge.

End of "WATER TO MY SOUL"

END OF ACT III

EPILOGUESCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - JANUARY 2037 - DAY

23A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

The VanDams prepare themselves for
the Michigan Bicentennial Parade.

LIZZIE
(Narrating)

Year after year, still doing Harbor Days. Every
time, I'm there. I *can* cross a bridge. Yay me,
facing my trauma. Huh...

Amanda ripped apart the agreement, so Elk
Rapids and her favorite Lake House are ours
again. The kids did it: they saved the world
from one data center! Many more to go...

And Lulu ended up turning our life story into a
musical for her high school senior year project
then she developed it at U of M...

VANDAMS

Ew...

Lulu flips them off before turning
her hand back into a mitten.

LIZZIE

Two of her musicals, *Dearborn* and *Elk Rapids*,
about a deer colony and anthropomorphic lakes?
They are now touring in a town near you. These
musicals helped raise funds to keep the Lake
House when the time came when Willy is no
longer paying the property taxes.

Cherry secretly holds a tablet and
places Willy-Milly's photo on it.

Willy and Milly manifest, lost
once again in the Audience.

Cherry waves. Perry and Shelby run
in and mess with Cherry.

Lulu and Petoskey fix up the Lake
House.

LAWMAKERS swear in Amanda.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Amanda was sworn in as our lieutenant governor. She doesn't show up to break ties in the Senate and the taxpayers pay for her lavish vacations. She'd be the perfect Vice President.

AMANDA

Don't give me any ideas. Let AI do the work!

LIZZIE

At least, she's using some power to push universal mental healthcare.

Lulu and Petoskey finish the Lake House.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Petoskey worked the shipyard like me and his father. And he used such skills to fix up the Lake House.

The rest of the VanDams come and watch the Great Lakes together.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

The Great Lakes is water to our souls...

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

SCENE 2

EXT. LANSING - JANUARY 26, 2037 - DAY

The Michigan Bicentennial Parade ramps up in the state capital.

Jacob is dressed like Eminem.

JACOB

My palms be sweaty, knees weak, arms are heavy.

Cherry hands spaghetti to Jacob.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Love my mom's spaghetti~

Welcome to Michigan's Bicentennial Celebration! Thanks for inviting me as your Grand Marshall. Last I hosted a parade it was Elk Rapids Harbor Days in 2022. Since then, I have won several Tony Awards and a few Razzies. Them cameras make my hands look big.

Anywho, as you know, Michigan officially became the 26th state in the United States on January 26, 1837.

(MORE)

JACOB (CONT'D)

As this year is the 200th anniversary of our statehood, we thought what better way to celebrate the Mitten than to share the best of our home state! Today is Pure Michigan!

We have floats and organizations representing the nearly three hundred cities and a thousand townships from all over our Great Lakes state!

And here comes Elk Rapids with the world-class VanDam family!

The VanDam family resembles the state's best from Aretha Franklin, Charles Lindbergh, Madonna, Stevie Wonder, to Christopher Wright (author of Pham's favorite book series, *Michigan Chillers*).

28-year-old Petoskey, his PARTNER, and their CHILD(REN) march alongside Lulu and her PARTNER.

The Aunties drive in the battered Ford Model T.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Who are we?!

24. "MICHIGAN"

MICHIGANDERS

OPE.
BRR...
WINTER IN OUR BONES.

LIZZIE

WHO M I?

MICHIGANDERS

WATER TO OUR SOULS!

PERRY

AM I KEEPING IT CHILL!

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

CHERRY

AM I HEARTWARMING!

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

SHELBY

AM I FULL OF FREE WILL!

Michigan

87.

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

M I MICHIGAN!

End of "MICHIGAN"

LOVE MICHIGAN